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Near-term growth outlook shows cautious resilience, says FinMin

However, domestic fundamentals remain broadly intact, mfg & services, PMIs are in expansionary territory, labour market is stable

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: With forecasts pointing to a below-normal monsoon and a likely moderation in economic activity, overall consumption demand may face headwinds in the coming months, and the near-term outlook for the Indian economy is one of cautious resilience, the Finance Ministry said in its latest Monthly Economic Review on Saturday.

However, domestic fundamentals remain broadly intact, manufacturing and services PMIs are in expansionary territory, the labour market is stable, and foreign exchange reserves provide meaningful insulation against external shocks, the finance ministry said.

At the same time, it said, the global environment has become materially more challenging since the onset of the West Asia conflict, with elevated crude prices, tightening financial conditions, and weakening growth momentum across major economies posing headwinds that India cannot fully insulate itself from.

The West Asia conflict has emerged as a major shock to the already fragile global recovery, with its effects increasingly visible across energy markets,



supply chains, trade routes and global financial conditions.

Elevated energy, transportation and logistics costs have revived inflationary pressures and renewed stagflation concerns across major economies, it said.

Confronted with these pressures, major central banks are expected to maintain restrictive monetary policy stances for longer than previously anticipated, pushing sovereign bond yields in advanced economies to multi-year highs, it said.

Across emerging markets, the impact remains uneven; energy-importing economies face mounting pressures from currency depreciation, capital

outflows, and higher import bills, while commodity exporters remain relatively better positioned, it said.

The report said the Indian economy maintained its growth momentum in April 2026, with E-way bill generation, PMI indices and electricity consumption remaining in expansionary territory.

However, the moderation in the Eight Core Industries Index and fuel consumption signals that global headwinds are gradually finding their way into select segments of domestic activity, it said.

On the inflation outlook, the report said, it warrants vigilance.

Highlights

» Forex reserves provide meaningful insulation against external shocks, the finance ministry said

» At the same time, the global environment has become materially more challenging since onset of West Asia conflict

» On the inflation outlook, the report said, it warrants vigilance

evident in the data for policy responses to be triggered, it said.

Looking ahead, the report said, the duration of the Strait of Hormuz disruption remains the single most consequential variable for India's external and price outlook.

Should normalisation occur soon, it said, the conditions for a broader-based recovery, supported by strong services exports and sustained investment commitments, are in place.

"Policy will need to remain agile across monetary, fiscal, and structural dimensions to navigate this period of compounded uncertainty, external and climatic, while keeping medium-term growth objectives firmly in view," it said.

Overall, India's macroeconomic position in May 2026 reflects cautious resilience, it said, adding that strong services exports, adequate foreign exchange reserves and a stable labour market provide a firm foundation.

However, it said, the confluence of elevated global energy prices, a depreciating rupee, rising upstream cost pressures and the prospect of a below-normal monsoon calls for sustained policy vigilance.

India, EAEU discussing limited interim trade deal: Russian Min

Describing negotiations as 'complex', Reshetnikov said that Indian side's requests were 'quite ambitious'

MOSCOW: India and the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) are discussing a "limited and temporary" trade arrangement covering selected groups of goods as part of negotiations on a proposed free trade agreement, Russia's Economic Development Minister Maxim Reshetnikov has said, according to a media report.

Describing the negotiations as "complex", Reshetnikov said on Friday that the Indian side's requests were "quite ambitious".

"Things are more complicated with India: the economy is larger, mutual interests are more complex, so to speak. And, frankly, our colleagues' requests are also quite ambitious," he said in an interview with the Vesti programme, according to the state-run TASS news agency.

"Therefore, we are currently discussing a limited and temporary free trade zone, that is, for a list of goods defined by product groups," he added.

Reshetnikov's remarks came hours after Russian President Vladimir Putin said negotiations in Kazakhstan's capital Astana, Putin was quoted as saying by TASS: "Last year trade agreements were concluded with Mongolia and the



The India-EAEU FTA process has gathered momentum in recent years. In August 2025, India & EAEU signed ToR to formally launch negotiations for a free trade pact

United Arab Emirates, as well as with Indonesia, intensifying negotiations on trade liberalisation with India."

The Russian president added that the EAEU supported launching talks on free trade agreements with new partners and that all aspects of such cooperation would be carefully analysed.

The EAEU is a five-member economic bloc comprising Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Armenia.

It was established in 2015 to promote economic integration through a common market, removal of trade barriers and coordination of economic policies among member states.

The India-EAEU free trade agreement process has gathered momentum in recent years.

In August 2025, India and the EAEU signed the Terms of Reference (ToR) to formally launch negotiations for a free trade agreement. At the time, the two sides said bilateral trade turnover had reached USD 69 billion in 2024, up seven per cent from the previous year.

The first round of negotiations was held in November last year.

Govt withdraws draft Sugarcane Control Order amid opposition

Move drew opposition from khandsari units & farmers

NEW DELHI: The Centre has withdrawn the draft Sugarcane (Control) Order, 2026, saying it needs to be revisited in the light of objections received from state governments and other stakeholders. The Food Ministry had circulated the draft for public comments, with a May 20 deadline.

"Based on the suggestions/comments received from state governments and other stakeholders, it is considered necessary to revisit the draft Sugarcane (Control) Order, 2026," the ministry said in an office memorandum.

The draft sought to replace the 60-year-old Sugarcane (Control) Order, 1966, with a new regulatory framework



that proposed, among other things, bringing the ethanol and khandsari sectors under government regulation.

The move drew opposition from khandsari units and farmers. The draft had proposed redefining a khandsari unit as one with more than 10 workers and a crushing capacity of over 500 tonnes per day. Under the existing rules, a khandsari unit is defined as one with 20 or more workers, with no capacity

limit. Sources said the proposed definition would have brought a large number of small-scale, labour-intensive units under the regulatory ambit, adversely affecting farmers who generally receive better prices from khandsari units than from sugar mills.

BJP MP Sanjeev Balyan, who represents Muzaffarnagar in Uttar Pradesh, said on social media the government had decided to withdraw the order "in the interest of farmers".

"This demonstrates that under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the government formulates every policy by placing the consent of the farmers and their welfare above all," he said.

Import duty exemption to improve cotton supply and lower input costs: Textile Ministry

NEW DELHI: The Centre's move to exempt all customs duties on cotton imports for five months till October 30 will ensure adequate availability of cotton for the textile industry, lower input costs and boost the competitiveness of Indian textiles, the Textile Ministry said on Saturday.

Industry bodies welcomed the decision, terming it a "much-needed relief" for the apparel sector.

"The measure is expected to augment the availability of cotton for the Indian textile and apparel sector and provide much-needed relief to the entire value chain," the Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) stated.

In a notification, the Finance Ministry said the import duty exemption will be



effective from June 1, 2026.

"The measure, implemented during the cotton off-season, will ensure adequate availability of cotton for the textile industry, support MSMEs, moderate input costs, and strengthen the competitiveness of Indian textiles" while safeguarding farmers' interests and ensuring market stability," the Textile Ministry stated.

AEPC Chairman A Sakthivel stated that the decision will particularly benefit

small and medium enterprises, which have been facing challenges due to the sharp increase in cotton and yarn prices.

He further noted that the removal of customs duty on cotton imports is the need of the hour and will help moderate domestic cotton prices.

In this regard, he appealed to all spinning mills to pass on the benefits of lower cotton costs by rationalising yarn prices. This will help stabilise the entire textile value chain and enable garment exporters to secure and execute export orders more competitively in the coming months, Sakthivel said.

"Amid the ongoing global volatility and uncertainty, the 11 per cent import duty on cotton was acting as a major hindrance to the Indian tex-

tile and apparel sector in raising its global competitiveness since our major Asian competitors already have duty-free access to cotton," Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI) Chairman Ashwin Chandran said.

The cotton import duty was driving up costs across the value chain and having a detrimental impact on efforts to scale India's textile and apparel exports, Chandran added.

India's textile exports are dominated by cotton. India is aiming for \$100 billion in textiles and apparel exports by 2030. "With this temporary relief in the cotton import duty, India's textile and apparel exporters can better leverage opportunities that are emerging from the FTAs," Chandran pointed out.

Middle East war straining energy supply: IMF, World Bank



WASHINGTON: The heads of the International Energy Agency, IMF, World Bank and WTO warned on Friday that the war in the Middle East was straining global energy supplies and hitting vulnerable economies hardest.

The US-Israel war on Iran has disrupted trade, rattled financial markets & raised concerns over global energy supplies, particularly via Strait of Hormuz.

The global institutions said that the world economy remained resilient, but the conflict was disproportionately affecting poorer countries through higher fuel and fertilizer prices, increased uncertainty, and risks to jobs.

The heads of the groups met on Thursday to discuss how they should respond to the economic impact of the war, they said in a joint statement, Reuters reported.

"If shipping flows do not return to normal, continued rapid depletion of global oil inventories ahead of peak summer oil demand in the Northern Hemisphere would present increasing risks for fuel security, market conditions & broader economic resilience," they said.

SWACHHATA PAKHWADA



Upholding the spirit of the Swachh Bharat Mission, NTPC Ltd is observing Swachhata Pakhwada 2026 across its stations from May 16 to 31, May 2026. The initiative aims to promote cleanliness, hygiene and environmental responsibility through employee and community participation. The Swachhata Pakhwada commenced with employees across all NTPC locations taking the Swachhata Pledge. Cleanliness drives, Swachhata rallies, Walkathons and awareness programmes are being organised across stations to encourage responsible practices, maintain clean surroundings. MPOST

Hindustan Zinc contributes ₹18,846 cr to exchequer in FY26

Company's cumulative contribution to exchequer over last five years stood at Rs 91,572 crore

UDAIPUR: Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL), India's only and the world's largest integrated zinc producer, contributed Rs 18,846 crore to the public exchequer in FY2025-26, according to its 9th Tax Transparency Report, underscoring the company's commitment to transparent governance, responsible business practices and nation-building.

The contribution, equivalent to 46 per cent of the company's revenue, took Hindustan Zinc's cumulative contribution to the exchequer over the past five years to Rs 91,572 crore.

The FY26 contribution comprised Rs 6,637 crore in

indirect taxes, Rs 5,073 crore in government royalties, including payments to the District Mineral Foundation (DMF) and National Mineral Exploration Trust (NMET), Rs 4,552 crore in income taxes, Rs 1,180 crore in dividends paid to the Government of India, Rs 755 crore in withhold-ing taxes, Rs 593 crore in other taxes borne and Rs 56 crore in other indirect contributions.

The company's effective tax rate for FY26 stood at 25.26 per cent.

The report has been prepared broadly in line with the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI 207: Tax 2019) framework and guided by the princi-



FY26 contribution comprised Rs 6,637 cr in indirect taxes, Rs 5,073 crore in govt royalties

ples of the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI)

and the International Council on Mining and Metals' Social and Economic Reporting Framework (ICMM-SeRF).

The tax contribution was supported by strong operational and financial performance during FY26. Hindustan Zinc reported revenue of Rs 40,844 crore, EBITDA of Rs 22,162 crore and profit after tax of Rs 13,832 crore.

The company achieved its highest-ever mined metal production of 1,114 kilotonnes during the year, while silver production stood at 627 tonnes.

Reflecting its market leadership, Hindustan Zinc was

included in the Nifty 100 and Nifty Next 50 indices from September 30, 2025, and subsequently in all Nifty ESG indices from December 31, 2025.

Since dis-investment, the company has delivered total shareholder returns of more than 1,400 times, with a share price CAGR of about 33 per cent.

As part of its governance framework, a Big Four audit firm independently assured the report's disclosures. Hindustan Zinc also retained the top global ranking in the metals and mining sector for the third consecutive year in the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment 2025. MPOST

IREDA posts profit of ₹492.63 crore in March qtr of FY26

The company had reported a net profit of Rs 501.55 crore in the same quarter a year ago

NEW DELHI: State-owned IREDA announced its financial results for March quarter and the financial year 2025-26.

The company has posted a net profit of Rs 492.63 crore during the March quarter of FY26. The firm had reported a net profit of Rs 501.55 crore in Q4 FY25, the company said.

During January-March, the company's total income rose to Rs 2,181.28 crore from Rs 1,915 crore in the fourth quarter of

CLOSER LOOK

» During Q4, the company's total income rose to Rs 2,181.28 crore from Rs 1,915 crore in Q4 of FY25

» For the entire FY26, IREDA posted a net profit of Rs 1,874 crore, up from Rs 1,698 crore in 2024-25

» Annual income also rose to Rs 8,338.89 crore from Rs 6,755.69 crore in FY2025-26

the preceding 2024-25 financial year.

Expenses increased to Rs

1,562.14 crore from Rs 1,285.91 crore in the last quarter of FY25.

For the entire FY26, IREDA

posted a net profit of Rs 1,874 crore, up from Rs 1,698 crore in 2024-25. Annual income also rose to Rs 8,338.89 crore from Rs 6,755.69 crore in FY25.

In a separate statement, the company said it has "posted the highest ever annual profit."

The Board of Directors recommended a final dividend of Rs 0.75 per equity share for the financial year 2025-26, subject to approval of shareholders in the ensuing Annual General

Meeting. The total dividend for the financial year is Rs 1.35/- per equity share, including interim dividend of Rs 0.60 per share.

In FY26, loan sanctions increased 9 per cent year on year to Rs 51,883 crore from Rs 47,453 crore in FY25. Loan Disbursements were at Rs 34,946 crore vs Rs 30,169 crore (posting a rise of 16%).

Loan Book increased 22 per cent to Rs 93,069 crore from 76,282 crore in FY25. PFI

NEW DELHI: The Civil Aviation Ministry on Saturday said DigiYatra facility, which has reduced the average airport entry time for passengers, will be available at 27 more airports by next year.

Digi Yatra enables contactless, seamless movement of passengers at airports using Facial Recognition Technology and is now available at 38 airports. In a release, the ministry said the DigiYatra app has enabled over 10 crore seamless journeys with

over 2.4 crore downloads.

"By replacing manual document verification, the platform has reduced average airport entry processing times from 15 seconds down to just 5 seconds per passenger," it added.

According to Civil Aviation Minister K Ramamohan Naidu, annual passenger traffic across Indian airports is projected to reach 50 crore by 2030 and double to nearly 100 crore by 2040.

"Right now, DigiYatra is active at 38 airports, and by

next year, 27 more airports will be enabled," he said and added that the app currently supports 11 languages.

By the end of the year, the aim is to provide support for 11 more regional languages through the DigiYatra app. Passenger data shared with DigiYatra remains encrypted & securely stored on the user's own device, shared only for a limited duration with origin airport for immediate verification purposes, the ministry said. PFI



CITY: Pg 5

Hottest May in 2 years; cleanest air in 5



NATION: Pg 7

Cong: Pradhan Mantri-Mantri Pradhan 'jugalbandi' destroying hopes of youth



FILM: Pg 14

'We live in slightly difficult times as creative people'

COACHING CENTRE HOUSED IN BUILDING; STUDENTS MAY BE AMONG THOSE INSIDE

Ten pulled out, more feared trapped

Massive rescue operation after multi-storey collapse near Saket Metro Station

DEADLY COLLAPSE

'It was found that an old building had collapsed and its debris had fallen on an adjacent cabin-like structure. We have been informed that the premises were being used as a canteen for medical students, and some people may be trapped'

Heavy machinery, hydraulic cutters, victim-location cameras, drilling equipment and trained sniffer dogs were also pressed into service to assist rescue efforts

Witnesses described hearing cries for help from beneath the debris moments after the building came down

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: At least ten people have been rescued and several others, including medical students, are feared trapped after a multi-storey commercial building collapsed near Saket Metro station in south Delhi's Saidulajab area on Saturday evening.

At least 10 people have been rescued so far from the debris of the building located on Western Marg under Khasra No. 261.

Rescue operations continued late into the night as teams from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Delhi Fire Services (DFS), Delhi Police and district administration worked to locate survivors believed to be trapped beneath the rubble.

The building, which housed Lingaya's Coaching Centre, cafes and office spaces, collapsed at around 7.44 pm, reducing the entire structure to a mound of broken concrete, twisted metal rods and shattered pillars. Authorities fear that several students and workers may still be trapped inside.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (South) Anant Mittal said police personnel



An ambulance leaves from the spot where a multi-storey building collapsed, on Saturday PTI



Rescue operation underway after a building collapsed at Saket area, on Saturday PTI

Preliminary information suggests that construction activity was underway on the upper floors of the building when the collapse occurred

responded immediately after receiving information about the collapse.

"At around 7.35 pm, beat staff received information about a major building collapse and a PCR call was

received within three minutes of the incident. Immediately, maximum staff from Mehrauli police station was rushed to the spot," Mittal said.

"It was found that an old building had collapsed and the

debris had fallen on an adjacent cabin-like structure. We have been informed that the premises were being used as a canteen for medical students and some people may be trapped. So far, around ten people have been evacuated. A green corridor was created to facilitate the movement of multiple ambulances. Rescue operations are being jointly carried out by the NDRF, DDMA, fire services

and Delhi Police," he added.

According to DFS officials, firefighters were rushed to the site immediately after an emergency call was received. Several fire tenders, emergency response vehicles and lighting units were deployed as the scale of the disaster became clear.

Heavy machinery, hydraulic cutters, victim-location cameras, drilling equipment and trained sniffer dogs were

also pressed into service to assist rescue efforts.

Officials said the collapsed structure also damaged an adjoining tin-shed canteen where several students were reportedly having dinner at the time of the incident.

Witnesses described hearing cries for help from beneath the debris moments after the building came down.

Continued on P6

BJP FORCED HOSPS TO DISCHARGE HIM DESPITE HAVING BLOOD CLOTS: MAMATA

THEY WANT TO KILL ME, says Abhishek after Sonarpur attack



MPOST BUREAU

KOLKATA: Trinamool Congress (TMC) national general secretary and Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee was attacked, heckled and pelted with stones, eggs and shoes during a visit to a party worker's house who was killed in "post-poll violence" in Sonarpur in South 24-Parganas on Saturday, triggering a fresh political confrontation in West Bengal.

The TMC alleged that the assault was a pre-planned attack orchestrated by BJP-backed miscreants, a charge denied by the saffron party.

Meanwhile, after returning to Kolkata, Banerjee was taken to two private hospitals where, Mamata Banerjee alleged, he was refused treatment due to "political pressure". The TMC supremo stated: "He had blood clots and severe injuries. He was taken to the ITU initially, but as DC South called and pressured the hospital, they refused to admit him despite being critically injured."

Abhishek Banerjee had gone to the Vivekanandanagar area under Sonarpur Municipality to meet the family of Sanju Karmakar, a Trinamool worker who was allegedly killed in post-poll violence. According to police and eyewitnesses, tensions escalated shortly after Banerjee abandoned his SUV and travelled on a motorcycle before finally reaching the residence of the



THE ATTACK

- » Some from the mob even attempted to physically attack Banerjee by raining blows and kicks on him
- » His shirt was reportedly torn during the scuffle, and his spectacles were damaged before he reached the Karmakar house
- » 'They want to kill me. I am not going to leave this place; I am not going to leave the family till the administration takes action. You can see no official is present here. Everything has been recorded on video. I am drawing the attention of the Governor and the High Court'
- » 'The people of the area, they are still meeting us and still greeting us with love and respect'

deceased party worker. On his way, eggs, stones, and shoes were allegedly hurled at the TMC leader.

Continued on P6

In today's paper

BUSINESS

IREDA POSTS Q4 PROFIT OF ₹492.63 CR 2

INTERNATIONAL

HEGSETH REASSURES PACIFIC ALLIES 4

CITY

IGI GETS SKYCAST 5

NATION

RTI ACTIVIST SHOT DEAD IN PHAGWARA 7

SPORT

RCB TAKE ON GT IN FINAL 8

CONGRESS CLEARS DECKS

DK's wait ends

Shivakumar to take oath as K'taka Chief Minister on June 3

MPOST BUREAU

BENGALURU:

After days of huddle and discussions in the Congress high command over leadership change in Karnataka, decks are now clear for D K Shivakumar to take over as the next Chief Minister of the state.

Karnataka Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot on Saturday invited Shivakumar, the newly elected CLP leader, to take oath as the chief minister of the state along with team members on June 3.

The invitation followed Shivakumar's meeting with the Governor at Lok Bhavan, where he staked his claim to form a new government. Shivakumar was accompanied by outgoing Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and other senior state leaders. The oath ceremony will take place at 4:05 PM on June 3, 2026, on the



TOP JOB AWAITS

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Continued on P6

GLITCH FORCES RETEST FOR 3,700+

After NEET, now CUET

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Already reeling under the fiasco of this year's NEET-UG exam paper leak, the National Testing Agency (NTA) again found itself battling a technical glitch which was faced by more than 3,700 CUET (UG) 2026 candidates on Saturday.

The candidates left their examination centres after a technical glitch delayed the start of Shift 1 of the test and the NTA announced that they will be given a one-time opportunity to reappear for the entrance exam for undergraduate admissions.

Following the disruption, examination timings were revised at the affected centres and "most candidates (about 95 per cent) were able to complete their exam once it resumed", the NTA said.

"Most candidates were able to complete their exam once it resumed. We understand that 3,765 candidates who were present and had completed biometric registration chose to leave before the exam could restart," the NTA said on X.

"For these candidates, NTA will hold a rescheduled examination as a one-time measure," it added. The new date and details will be announced separately, the agency said.

It also said that the technical service provider, TCS iON, "has been



TEST DAY TROUBLE

» 'Most candidates were able to complete their exam once it resumed'

» 'We understand that 3,765 candidates who were present and had completed biometric registration chose to leave before the exam could restart'

» 'The new date and details will be announced separately'

asked to conduct a root-cause analysis and submit its report immediately" after the glitch delayed the commencement of the examination at some centres.

"Earlier today, some centres faced a technical glitch that delayed the start of Shift 1. We know this was stressful, and we're sorry for the anxiety it caused. The technical service provider, TCS iON, Continued on P6

'Armed forces ready for Operation Sindoor 2.0'

MPOST BUREAU

PUNE: The armed forces are fully prepared for 'Operation Sindoor 2.0' if the need arises, Chief of Army Staff General Upendra Dwivedi said on Saturday, asserting that all three services are enhancing synergy for modern multi-domain warfare that extends beyond land, air and sea.

Speaking at a press conference on the sidelines of the passing-out parade of the 150th course of the National



AS FAR AS OPERATION SINDOOR IS CONCERNED, FIRSTLY, IT IS STILL CONTINUING. THERE IS A TEMPORARY CESSATION OF HOSTILITIES

Defence Academy (NDA) here, General Dwivedi noted that while a temporary cessation of

Continued on P6

DUST WALL ADVANCES



A huge dust storm approaches as it engulfs the skyline at Dungargarh, in Bikaner district, Rajasthan, on Saturday PTI

WHO LEADS? IYER, SANJU, TILAK

Asian Games: No Gill, no SKY; Vaibhav in

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's current T20 skipper Suryakumar Yadav, along with Test and ODI captain Shubman Gill, are the two prominent names missing, while teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has been inducted into the 30-strong longlist of men's probables that the BCCI has submitted to the IOA for the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya from September 19 to October 4.

It has been pre-decided that the BCCI will need to select two separate T20 teams as India's home white-ball series against the West Indies overlaps partly with the quadrennial extravaganza.



Shubman Gill being greeted by Vaibhav Sooryavanshi

The West Indies series comprises eight white-ball games -- three ODIs and five T20Is -- between September 27 to October 17. Since Gill is expected to

lead the team in ODIs, he hasn't been picked for the Asian Games.

While some players are common in both ODIs and T20Is, men's cricket event at the Asian

Games will take place between September 24 to October 3, forcing the selectors to create a bigger pool to pick two teams.

It is understood that Suryaku-

CLOSER LOOK

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mar is no longer in the larger scheme of things as far as 2028 Olympic Games and the next T20 World Cup is concerned, and his name not featuring in the Asian Games longlist is a no-brainer.

The captaincy candidates in that Asian Games list would be Shreyas Iyer, Sanju Samson and Tilak Varma.

The list of bowlers has Jasprit Bumrah's name in it although ODIs could be his priority at that point in time taking the 2027 World Cup into account.

Harshit Rana is expected to be fit by then and has been kept in the long-list along with Prasidh Krishna and Arshdeep Singh.

Continued on P6

Back on mat, out in semis



Vinesh falls 4-6

AMANPREET SINGH

NEW DELHI: The cheers were loud, the emotions raw and the expectations of a fairy-tale comeback unmistakable, but Vinesh Phogat's return to competitive wrestling ended in heartbreak on Saturday following a 4-6 loss against Meenakshi Goyat in the 53kg semifinals of the Asian Games selection trials.

Vinesh thus fell short in her bid to re-enter the national team after the trauma of the 2024 Paris Olympics.

"I do not feel I have failed. I was fighting a whole system. We had to fight for every point. I was not given a fair deal. I do not grudge the athletes who fought with me. They also had dreamt of fighting against me. I will come back," Vinesh said before leaving the venue.

Back on the mat for the first time since her devastating disqualification from the Olympic final in 2024, Vinesh battled through controversy, crowd-fuelled drama and a gruelling quarterfinal against Nishu Kumari before

Continued on P6

US disables another ship trying to breach blockade & reach Iran

Gambia-flagged bulk carrier Lian Star ignored warnings from US forces as it tried to enter an Iranian port

US Secretary of War said China is no longer just building up its military forces to take Taiwan, it's 'actively training for it, every day'

Hegseth, who was with

However, he said it was still an American priority to ensure that China is not allowed to

“We share a clear-eyed assessment of that security environment and a mutual understanding that a Pacific dominated by any hegemony would unravel the regional balance of power and undermine the equilibrium we all seek.”

China claims the democratic self-governing island as its own, and Xi has not ruled out using force to take it. The US is required by law to help provide Taiwan with the means to defend itself, though follows a policy of "strategic ambiguity" on whether it would intervene militarily if China were to attack the island.

AGENCIES

Trump has repeatedly claimed that he helped secure peace between India & Pak following a four-day military conflict last year triggered by the terror attack in J&K's Pahalgam that killed 26 people. AGENCIES

With the latest action, US military has stopped six ships

A fragile ceasefire has held since April 7. Now the region and wider world await word on whether a deal is being reached to extend it by 60 days while

US President Donald Trump met with advisers on Friday but has yet to decide on whether to move ahead with a deal to extend the ceasefire and reopen the strait. Iran has said the deal had not been finalised. AGENCIES

The operation was conducted in Darra Adam Khel town of Kohat district, some 30 km southwest of Peshawar on Friday. Two soldiers also died in a fierce exchange of fire, police said. The operation was launched based on intelligence regarding the presence of ter-

The situation in the area is being closely monitored with heightened surveillance in place, police said. AGENCIES

Among the recommendations was a switch to low-dose aspirin. AGENCIES

Please join us on

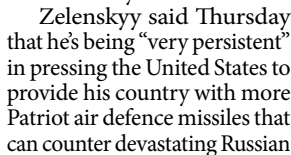
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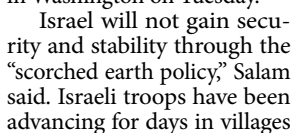
The passengers were among thousands of Afghans who recently returned from Pak-

In a separate accident in the eastern province of Nuristan, a car fell off the road into a river on Friday night, injuring the driver and leaving four passengers missing, the governor's office said Saturday. AGENCIES

Ukraine has expanded its mid- and long-range strike capabilities, deploying drone and missile technology that it has developed domestically to battle Russia's 4-year-old invasion. Attacks on Russian oil assets that play a key



The situation in southern Lebanon was discussed during a meeting on Saturday between Lebanon's president and prime minister who later said in a statement that they will intensify their contacts to make Israel stop demolition and bulldozing of homes and historical sites as well as its evacuation warning.



US commander meets with Cuban military officials

General Francis Donovan, met with Lieutenant General Roberto Legrá Sotolongo, other Cuban military officials

Top Trump aides, including Secretary of State Marco Rubio and CIA chief John Ratcliffe, also have met with Cuban officials to explore possible improvements in relations. But the US side has come away unimpressed from those talks, leading to even more sanctions imposed on the Cuban government.

The US military has a handful of Navy ships, including at least one amphibious assault ship, in the Caribbean, a much smaller force than was present at the time of the Maduro raid. AGENCIES

When Delhi burned but the air cleared

Hottest May in two years; cleanest air in five

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The weather in Delhi has experienced extremes this month, with the city recording its hottest May in two years while also enjoying its cleanest air in five years. This unusual weather includes heatwaves, unseasonably warm nights, and thunderstorms.

Delhi's average maximum temperature for May reached 39.7 degrees Celsius, with the average minimum temperature at 25.8 degrees Celsius.

The last hotter May occurred in 2024, when the average maximum and minimum temperatures were 41.7 degrees Celsius and 26.5 degrees Celsius, respectively.

Heatwave conditions were noted from May 18 to 21, with maximum temperatures exceeding 46 degrees Celsius in some areas of the city. Overall, Delhi received 17.61 mm of rainfall during the month.

The city also experienced unusually warm nights in May, with minimum temperatures hitting 32.8 degrees Celsius on May 26 and 31.9 degrees Celsius on May 21—among the highest nighttime temperatures recorded in the city in the last 14 years, according to data from the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The IMD defines a heatwave as a situation where the maximum temperature exceeds 40 degrees Celsius and is 4.5 to 6.4 degrees Celsius above normal.

A warm night is declared when the maximum temperature remains at 40 degrees Celsius or higher, and the minimum temperature is also 4.5 to 6.4 degrees Celsius above normal.

Mahesh Palawat of Skymet Weather attributed the month's fluctuating weather to a combination of western disturbances and induced cyclonic circulations over Rajasthan and adjoining areas, and moisture-laden winds from the Bay of Bengal. Experts said frequent western disturbances and associated weather systems led to early pre-monsoon activity, leading to low temperatures during the first half of May.



People cover themselves during rainfall at Kartavya Path on Saturday PTI

Highlights

- » Delhi's average maximum temperature for May reached 39.7 degrees Celsius, with the average minimum temperature at 25.8 degrees Celsius
- » Experts said frequent western disturbances and associated weather systems led to early pre-monsoon activity

As these systems weakened, temperatures rose sharply and

heatwave conditions developed across parts of Delhi before another spell of strong pre-monsoon activity returned towards the end of the month, they said. Palawat mentioned that thunderstorms, rain and gusty winds intensified during the latter part of May, bringing widespread weather activity across the capital and providing relief from the intense heat over the past few days.

Despite the hotter conditions, Delhi recorded its cleanest AQI in May in about five years. An analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA) showed that the capital's average AQI was 161 until May 29, the lowest for the month since 2021, when it was 144.

On Saturday, May 30, Delhi recorded a satisfactory AQI of 85, following widespread rainfall and strong winds. This represented the cleanest air quality day in May since 2023 and the fourth satisfactory air quality day this month.

Haryana to supply 1,000 cusecs of water: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Haryana government has assured supply of 1,000 cusecs of water, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday.

Gupta held a detailed review meeting on drinking water challenges and water supply situation with Delhi Jal Board (DJB) officials.

"To tackle the water-related challenges, an assurance has been given by Haryana to maintain a minimum of 1,000 cusecs of water supply through the Munak Canal," she said after speaking to Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini.

Being a landlocked city, Delhi is dependent on neighbouring states of Haryana and Uttar Pradesh for raw water



Rekha Gupta during the meeting with the Delhi Jal Board officials PTI

supply. DJB's overall average production capacity ranges between 990 and 1,000 million gallons per day (MGD) of drinking water, including the tubewells. The CM also said that efforts are being made to provide relief to the people through more than 980 tank-

The CM said efforts are being made to provide relief to the people through more than 980 tankers

ers and over 6,000 daily trips.

In the past several days, the DJB had been struggling to maintain its average water production which has fallen by around 90 million gallons per day (MGD) from its target of 1,002 MGD this year.

In the past week, the DJB

received 11,055 complaints on its helpline, out of which more than 8,500 complaints have been resolved, claimed officials.

"In the past few days, the DJB was receiving around 900 to 924 cusecs of water through the Munak Canal, the neighbouring state has assured to provide 100 cusecs more than the allocated amount of 924 cusecs," a DJB official said.

Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the water level at Wazirabad has fallen from its normal pond level of 674.5 feet to nearly 668 feet, resulting in a shortage of raw water and affecting water production by nearly 80-100 MGD.

"This situation has been aggravated by the prolonged dry spell in the upper reaches of the Yamuna," Singh added.

900 MGD output despite Yamuna dip, says Verma

NEW DELHI: Water Minister Parvesh Verma on Saturday said the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) has been able to maintain daily water production of around 900 million gallons per day (MGD) despite a sharp decline in the Yamuna's water level at the Wazirabad Barrage, which has affected raw water availability in the capital.

Verma said Delhi's water requirement rises to around 1,250 MGD during the peak summer season, but a significant drop in the Yamuna's level has reduced water production by nearly 80-100 MGD.

"The water level at Wazirabad has fallen from its normal pond level of 674.5 feet to nearly 668 feet, resulting in a shortage of raw water. The situation has been aggravated by a prolonged dry spell in the upper reaches of the Yamuna," he said. The minister said the DJB has undertaken a series of emergency measures to minimise the impact of the shortfall and ensure uninterrupted supply to residents.

According to Verma, additional raw water has been diverted from the Carrier Line Canal through the Twin Mains system to the Wazirabad intake, while emergency pumping arrangements have been installed in the dry riverbed to augment supply.

These pumping arrangements are contributing nearly 40 MGD of additional raw water, while around 130 MGD is being diverted from the canal system. Together, the measures have helped sustain operations at the Wazirabad and Chandrawal treatment plants, he said.

"Despite the difficult circumstances, DJB has been able to maintain daily water production of around 900 MGD and continues to supply water to the vast majority of households across the city," he said.

Mayor opens new lift at MCD zone office

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Mayor Pravesh Wahi inaugurated a newly installed modern lift at the City-SP Zone Office of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), describing the initiative as part of the civic body's efforts to improve accessibility and public service delivery.

The inauguration ceremony was attended by Councillor Suman Kumar Gupta, City-SP Zone Deputy Commissioner Kanika, senior officials, and staff members of the Corporation.

Speaking on the occasion, Wahi said the MCD was committed to strengthening its infrastructure to make civic services more efficient and citizen-friendly. He noted that

the new lift would particularly benefit senior citizens, persons with disabilities, and visitors who frequently access the office for civic-related work.

The Mayor said the Corporation was undertaking several infrastructure improvement projects across its offices to create a more accessible and modern environment for residents. The installation of the lift, he added, marked another step towards enhancing public convenience and administrative efficiency.

Councillor Suman Kumar Gupta welcomed the development and thanked the MCD administration for providing the facility. He said the lift would make it easier for residents to access services and improve the overall experience of visitors at the office.

Police bust ISI-linked terror module, arrest 8

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: In a major intelligence-led operation, the Delhi Police Special Cell has dismantled an alleged international and inter-state terror module linked to Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI), the Mumbai underworld and Pakistan-based operative Shahzad Bhatti.

Eight operatives, including a Nepali national, have been arrested for allegedly plotting grenade attacks and firing incidents targeting vital installations, security establishments and police personnel in Delhi, Mumbai, Punjab, Chandigarh and other cities.

Police recovered four Pakistan-made hand grenades, two Glock pistols and 24 live cartridges from three accused

who were intercepted in Delhi. Investigators also seized a stolen Pulsar motorcycle, a stolen Honda Activa scooter and mobile phones containing alleged communications with handlers based in Pakistan.

According to Delhi Police, the operation was carried out by a Special Cell team led by DCP Praveen Kumar Tripathi under the supervision of Additional CP Pramod Kumar Kushwaha. An FIR has been registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

The investigation revealed that the module was allegedly being directed by ISI-linked handlers Shahzad Bhatti, Munna Jhingada and Yawar Khan.

Cleared for takeoff: India's first SkyCast system debuts at IGI

Can generate advance weather alerts up to three hours ahead

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: India on Saturday inaugurated its first Sky-Cast System at Indira Gandhi International Airport, becoming the 19th country in the world to deploy an integrated atmospheric remote sensing system for aviation weather monitoring.

Union Minister Jitendra Singh, who inaugurated the facility at Glide Path 10 of the airport, described it as the beginning of a new era in Indian aviation. The event was attended by Earth Sciences Secretary M. Ravichandran, senior officials of the India Meteorological Department (IMD), the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), GMR and representatives from the aviation sector.

The SkyCast facility combines multiple atmospheric observation technologies, including a Radar Wind Profiler, SODAR, Microwave Radiometer, Ground-based Fog Aerosol Spectrometer (GFAS)



In Short

- » Singh said the technology would be particularly useful in Delhi, where pollution particles interact with fog and sharply reduce visibility during winter
- » Singh said the technology would be particularly useful in Delhi, where

pollution particles interact with fog and sharply reduce visibility during winter

» The system can generate advance weather alerts up to three hours ahead, helping flight crews determine the safest landing windows and reducing diversions, delays and cancellations

and CL61 lidar-based ceilometer. Together, these systems provide real-time atmospheric intelligence to pilots, airlines and air traffic management agencies.

The system can gener-

ate advance weather alerts up to three hours ahead, helping flight crews determine the safest landing windows and reducing diversions, delays and cancellations.

Highlighting its signif-

icance for the national capital, Singh said the technology would be particularly useful in Delhi, where pollution particles interact with fog and sharply reduce visibility during winter. "India is moving towards an era of fog-free flights through scientific innovation," he said.

The scientific foundation for SkyCast was laid through the Winter Fog Experiment (WiFEX), a joint initiative of IITM and IMD launched at IGI Airport in 2015. The programme generated crucial data on fog formation, aerosol-cloud interactions and visibility reduction in urban environments.

Ravichandran said the vertical atmospheric profiles generated by SkyCast would strengthen weather forecasting capabilities beyond aviation and could benefit several sectors. He added that similar systems would be installed at airports across the country, with the next facility planned at Jewar Airport.



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1.	CAW Cell Head Quarter	SPUWAC, Nanakpura, Delhi, near Moti Bagh Gurudwara, Delhi-110021	7835075012
2.	New Delhi	CAW Cell, Room no 104, 1st floor PS Mandir Marg, New Delhi District	9971814565
3.	East	CAW Cell, DCP Office, Mandawali Fazalpur, Gazipur, IP Extension, New Delhi	9540426425
4.	North East	CAW Cell, Old Building of R.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi-110093	8800740099
5.	Central	CAW Cell, 1st Floor, Police Station Kamla Market, Near Girdhar Lal Hospital, New Delhi	9649930520
6.	North	CAW Cell, PS Subzi Mandi, Ground Floor, Near Hindu Rao Hospital, Delhi	7678696088
7.	South East	CAW Cell, Sri Niwas Puri Police Post, Amar Colony, New Delhi	8178985651 8708464944
8.	Rohini	CAW Cell, P.S. Begumpur, Rohini, New Delhi	9911331131
9.	South	CAW Cell South, Ashok Vihar, Saket (Behind Anupam PVR)	99111 65959
10.	Dwarka	CAW Cell, PS Dabri, 1st Floor, New Building, Delhi	9971757628
11.	Shahdara	CAW Cell, 123, Block F, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095	98113 57769
12.	Outer	CAW Cell, 2nd Floor, PP Bakkarwala JJ Colony, (PS Mundka), Delhi-110041	9999516034
13.	South West	CAW Cell, 2nd floor, PS Delhi Cantt.	9650265605
14.	West	CAW Cell, 1st Floor, Police Station Kirti Nagar, Near Timber Market, New Delhi	6828401611
15.	North West	CAW Cell, Near M2K Cinema, Rani Bagh, Delhi	9213999334
16.	Outer North	CAW Cell, Outer North Distt., D-Block Sector 11, Rohini near Titiksha Public School	90134 01355 98719 59009

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DP/9890/2026

MASSIVE DUST STORM SWEEPS RAJASTHAN

Rain brings relief to parts of north India

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A massive dust storm barrelled through several parts of Rajasthan on Saturday, even as an active western disturbance triggered rain in most of the northern states, bringing much-needed relief from the sweltering heat that baked the region for the past few days.

In Rajasthan, the storm triggered by a western disturbance affected Churu, Bikaner, Hanumangarh, Sri Ganganagar, Nagaur, Didwana-Kuchaman, Alwar and Sikar districts, while Jaipur witnessed strong winds followed by rain.

A dust storm with lesser intensity also hit parts of Delhi on Saturday amid red and orange alerts, as the India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecast thunderstorms, lightning, hail and rain.

According to the weather office, a dust storm followed by a severe thunderstorm accompanied by lightning, hail and light to moderate rain is very likely over parts of central, northeast, southwest, west, northwest and north Delhi.



Clouds hover over the hills after rainfall, in Shimla, Saturday PTI

The wind speeds are expected to range between 70 and 90 kmph, gusting up to 100 kmph, it said.

The weather change is being driven by an active western disturbance affecting north-west India, along with an associated cyclonic circulation, which has enhanced moisture and instability over the region, the IMD said.

Rain also lashed several parts of Punjab and Haryana on Saturday, bringing respite from the scorching heat as the maximum temperatures dropped several notches below normal in both states.

In Punjab, showers were reported in Mohali, Pathankot, Hoshiarpur, Rupnagar, Amritsar, Ludhiana, Patiala, Fazilka and Ferozepur, while Pathankot witnessed a hailstorm.

In Haryana, Narnaul, Sirsa, Gurugram, Rohtak, Sonipat and Karnal saw rain, according to the local weather office.

Chandigarh, the joint capital of Punjab and Haryana, received 18.2 mm of rainfall, and logged a maximum temperature of 25.3 degrees Celsius, 14 notches below the season's average.

UP: 31 killed in rain related incidents

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: At least 31 people were killed in rain-related incidents and lightning strikes across Uttar Pradesh as strong storms and widespread rainfall battered the state over the past two days, bringing relief from the intense summer heat but leaving a trail of destruction.

The highest number of deaths was reported from the Bundelkhand region,

where 15 people lost their lives. Hamirpur accounted for six deaths, followed by Banda with three fatalities. Two people each were killed in Mahoba and Jalaun districts.

Four people died in Kaushambi, while Saharanpur and Deoria reported two deaths each. One death each was reported from Pratapgarh, Ambedkar Nagar, Ballia, Maharaiganj, Mathura, Unnao, Fatehpur and Rampur.

Most places in the two states reported maximum temperatures 8-10 degrees Celsius below normal, weather data showed.

Uttar Pradesh also experienced relief as rain brought temperatures down in parts of the state. Rainfall ranging from 3 mm to 18 mm was recorded in Bahraich, Muzaffarnagar, Lakhimpur Kheri, Najibabad and Meerut.

Parts of Himachal Pradesh also witnessed light to moderate rain and hailstorms, prompting the Met depart-

ment to issue a yellow warning for adverse weather conditions in most parts of the state.

A hailstorm accompanied by heavy downpour lashed Shimla and its adjoining areas on Friday evening. Hailstorms were also reported from Chopal and Kotkhai in Shimla district.

The weather office has warned of hail, thunderstorm, lightning and gusty winds at isolated places in 10 out of the 12 districts in the state on Sunday.

REVIEWS BORDER SECURITY IN GUJARAT

Shah calls for crackdown on illegal infiltration and financial crimes

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BHUJ: Union Home minister Amit Shah chaired a high-level security review meeting in Bhuj to assess security challenges in Gujarat's border and coastal districts along the India-Pakistan border.

The meeting was attended by Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, senior state government officials, district magistrates and superintendents of police from Kutch, Vav-Tharad and Patan, along with security and administrative officers.

Discussions unfolded around preparedness levels in coastal belts. Oversight extended to district units positioned at national margins. Strategic inputs came from field commanders present. Emphasis appeared on coordination between agencies operating there. Assessment followed recent patterns in cross-border activity. Measures discussed aim to strengthen monitoring systems already in place.

It was noted that progress on border barriers has had measurable effects. Maritime safeguards have since been reinforced, contributing to broader stability along coastal regions. With



these developments, unauthorised entries now occur at minimal levels. Smuggling across frontiers has sharply declined due to consistent enforcement measures taken by local authorities. Security conditions overall show marked improvement throughout Gujarat.

Across the 15 kms border zone, unlawful settlements are now met without exception by immediate enforcement measures, as ordered by the Home minister. Surveillance operations, meanwhile, have intensified around locations where extremist influence could take root near frontier areas.

Not only did he urge district authorities to track population shifts near borders, but also to align efforts in detecting and removing unauthorised entrants. With focus on localised threats, attention was placed on crafting tailored protocols by each administration. Drone

movements, drug smuggling, alongside unlawful movement of people shaped the concerns outlined. Specific procedures, adjusted per region, became a point of emphasis under his direction.

Across each border district, a new structure may take shape through Security Coordination Groups suggested by the Home Minister. These units would bring together personnel from the Border Security Force alongside members of the Indian Coast Guard.

Representation extends to officials from the Income Tax Department along with counterparts in the Enforcement Directorate. Financial oversight enters via participation from various banking institutions.

The aim emerges subtly - not through declaration but design - enhancing alignment among agencies without centralising control.

Alertness must increase, Shah emphasised, regarding hawala channels alongside mule accounts and phantom firms near frontiers. Oversight on odd monetary flows plus tax mismatches under GST should sharpen, especially where borders lie.

From Page 1

Ten pulled out

Balwant Yadav, whose daughter was injured in the collapse, said she was present at the canteen when the building suddenly crashed.

"At the time of the incident, around 30 to 35 students were present in the canteen. Most of them were students preparing for various medical entrance examinations. My daughter suffered a fracture in her leg and is currently undergoing treatment," he said.

District administration officials present at the site indicated that more people could still be trapped beneath the rubble.

Dharamveer Singh, an official from the district magistrate's office, said rescue personnel were attempting to reach those visible under the debris.

"Around six to seven people are still believed to be trapped under the collapsed building. Their faces can be seen from outside, and NDRF personnel are working to rescue them. The exact number of fatalities, if any, can only be confirmed after all trapped individuals are evacuated and shifted to hospital," he said.

Preliminary information suggests that construction activity was underway on the upper floors of the building when the collapse occurred.

According to the sources, an unauthorised construction and structural alterations were allegedly being carried out on the upper levels while commercial establishments continued to function on the lower floors.

The ownership of the property, according to Municipal Corporation of Delhi records, is linked to Dharamvir Sejwal and Satyavir Sejwal.

Residents alleged that both individuals have been associated with unauthorised construction activities in Saidulajab and neighbouring areas for several years.

Locals claimed that civic authorities had conducted demolition drives against multiple allegedly illegal structures in the locality last year.

Residents further alleged that several constructions linked to the owners were raised without adhering to prescribed building norms and safety standards.

They also claimed that low-cost and poor-quality construction materials were frequently used in such projects, raising concerns about structural safety.

Dharamvir Sejwal is also alleged to have faced multiple FIRs related to unauthorised construction violations in the past, although officials have not yet commented on the status of those cases.

Police officials said the immediate priority remains rescuing those trapped under the debris.

Once rescue operations conclude, investigators will examine the ownership of the building, permissions obtained for construction activities and whether any violations or lapses contrib-

uted to the collapse.

A detailed investigation has been initiated to determine the exact cause of the incident and fix responsibility for what could become one of the most serious building collapse tragedies witnessed in the national capital in recent years.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that every possible effort is being made to safely rescue those trapped in the building collapse near Saket Metro Station.

Expressing her concern about the incident, Gupta stated that the situation is being closely monitored.

"Teams from NDRF, Delhi Fire Services, Delhi Police, DDMA, MCD, CATS and Civil Defence are carrying out rescue operations on a war footing," Gupta said in a post on X.

Abhishek

Some from the mob even attempted to physically attack Banerjee by raining blows and kicks on him.

Visuals from the spot telecast by news channels showed security personnel struggling to escort Banerjee through the mob as several people attempted to confront him physically.

As the situation deteriorated, he was seen wearing a police helmet for protection. His shirt was reportedly torn during the scuffle, and his spectacles were damaged before he reached the Karmakar house.

Several people were seen questioning the Trinamool leader and accused the party of failing to protect people during previous incidents of political violence. Some alleged they had been forced to leave their homes following threats from local Trinamool leaders.

Addressing the media from the spot, Abhishek alleged that the attack was a planned attempt on his life and blamed BJP supporters for orchestrating the violence. He also accused the administration of failing to provide adequate security despite prior information about his visit.

"They want to kill me. I am not going to leave this place; I am not going to leave the family till the administration takes action. You can see no official is present here. Everything has been recorded on video. I am drawing the attention of the Governor and the High Court," he said.

According to a video circulating on social media, an official was purportedly heard saying that requests had been made for additional police personnel to handle the situation, but the required support was not provided. However, Millennium Post could not independently verify the authenticity of the video or the claims made in it.

Elucidating, Abhishek said that he had instructed those accompanying him to immediately contact officials, send WhatsApp messages and retain screenshots if their calls went unanswered.

Claiming that repeated attempts to reach the adminis-

tration had failed, he said all evidence of the incident had been documented and that he would pursue legal action.

Describing the attack, Banerjee said: "They threw bricks, eggs, and pelted stones. Please tell me what this is. And all the people standing nearby, the people of the area, and they are still meeting us and still greeting us with love and respect. Go and ask those who are doing hooliganism here. We have all the video evidence. There's a community hall nearby. From 11 am onwards, goons were kept in that community hall to pelt stones."

Later in the evening, Banerjee was taken to Apollo Hospital, accompanied by Mamata Banerjee, where she alleged that despite sustaining injuries during the attack, he was denied admission.

After being turned away by Apollo Hospital, he was also allegedly refused admission at Belle Vue Clinic.

He was initially taken to the ITU for tests before being released.

The TMC supremo termed the alleged refusal unprecedented and politically motivated. She stated: "At Apollo, they wanted to take 'permission' before admitting him. What permission do you need to treat a patient? Same at the Belle Vue Clinic, he had blood clots and several injury marks on his body. They initially took him to the ITU, acknowledging the severity. I was sitting with the officials and I heard they received threat calls. Finally, when DC South called the authority, they refused Abhishek's admission."

She added: "Abhishek is returning home. I'll arrange the necessary medical care there with the help of our house physician."

Later, sharing photographs of a woman attacking Abhishek Banerjee, TMC wrote on social media: "Sushmita Dutta, a @BJP-4Bengal worker, was seen in multiple videos ATTACKING Shri @abhishekaite ! She shares several pictures with BJP leaders @paulagnimitra1 & @SuvenduWB, among others. So did THEY INSTRUCT HER TO TAKE UP SUCH VIOLENT ACTS? Or did they promise to protect her regardless of her HEINOUS & INHUMANE ACTIONS? Is this the democracy BJP workers understand? Is this what politics have come down to in our country?"

Meanwhile, the BJP denied involvement in the attack and said the matter should be investigated.

CUET

has been asked to conduct a root-cause analysis and submit its report immediately," the agency said.

"We know that today's unfortunate technical disruption caused distress for some CUET (UG) 2026 candidates. Candidates who did their biometric registration and were present at their examination centres today, but couldn't complete their examination due to this technical glitch, will get another opportunity for examination," the NTA said on X.

Earlier, the agency had said that the technical issue had been

resolved and the examination was being conducted with full compensatory time so that no candidate was disadvantaged.

"TCS has reported that a technical glitch at their end delayed the commencement of CUET UG 2026 at some centres on Saturday. The issue has since been resolved, and the exam is being conducted with full compensatory time so that no candidate is disadvantaged," the NTA said on X.

In a statement, K Krithivasan, CEO and Managing Director at TCS, said that "a brief technical issue" caused a delay of around two hours in the morning shift of the CUET-UG examination.

"The issue was promptly identified and resolved by our technical teams and the examination has since resumed without any impact to the sanctity of the exam. We regret the inconvenience," the company said in a statement.

It added that its teams are "actively monitoring all systems" and remain committed to working closely with NTA "to ensure seamless conduct of the computer based tests."

Several students and parents reported the delay on X and alleged lack of communication at the examination centres.

"CUET 2026 students forced to wait 3-4 hours due to technical glitches. No proper communication, no arrangements, students and parents suffering in extreme heat. This is unacceptable for a national-level exam," an X user posted.

"CUET exam delayed. The centre for most kids was many miles away from the main city. Kids and parents left at 6 am to reach the centre on time. At 11 am, parents are told that the exam has not even started. Meanwhile, kids are just sitting inside waiting," a parent said.

The Common University Entrance Test-Undergraduate, or CUET-UG, is a standardised, national-level entrance exam conducted by the NTA for admissions into undergraduate degree programmes across central, state, and select private universities.

Since its introduction in 2022, the second-largest entrance test in the country has witnessed multiple operational disruptions in different phases, including last-minute changes in exam centres, delayed entry and commencement at several venues, and technical issues such as server and login failures at select centres.

There have also been instances of exam cancellations at some centres due to system-related problems, as well as rescheduling of tests for the affected candidates.

In certain cases, students reported confusion over admit card details and exam dates, leading to missed attempts. The recurring issues have created concerns among the students and parents over the smooth conduct of the examination.

The CUET-UG has been conducted in the computer-based test (CBT) mode since the 2025 cycle, with the NTA citing improved standardisation, efficiency and logistics in the conduct of the nationwide entrance test.

Replacing multiple entrance tests, the CUET-UG aims to provide a uniform assessment platform, and evaluates candidates on

language skills, domain-specific subjects, and general aptitude, aligning with the National Education Policy 2020 to promote inclusivity and equal opportunities. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Op Sindoor

hostilities currently exists, all three services are preparing intensely for the next phase should it take place.

India launched Operation Sindoor, a military exercise to destroy terror infrastructure in Pakistan in May 2025, in response to the Pahalgam terror attack, which claimed 26 lives in April.

"As far as Operation Sindoor is concerned, firstly, it is still continuing. There is a temporary cessation of hostilities. So the Indian Army and all the three services are preparing well for Operation Sindoor 2.0 if it takes place," he said.

He noted that future conflicts would increasingly be influenced by emerging domains such as space, cyber and cognitive warfare.

Modern battlefields have become highly transparent, General Dwivedi said, adding that military planners must remain cautious about deployments and force protection measures.

"What we have seen over a period of time is 24/7. The battlefield is so transparent that every movement is known to the other side. Therefore, we have to be very cautious in terms of our deployment, in terms of our employment, and the protection which is required to protect our troops as well as the civilians in the border areas," he said.

DK's wait

Lok Bhavan premises, the Governor's letter to Shivakumar stated.

Earlier, Shivakumar, who is also the state Congress president, was elected leader of the Congress legislature party, paving the way for him to take over as the next chief minister of the state. A resolution to this effect was moved by Siddaramaiah. AICC General Secretaries K C Venugopal and Randeep Singh Surjewala arrived in Bengaluru Saturday to attend the CLP meeting in Vidhana Soudha's conference hall. It followed Governor's acceptance of Siddaramaiah's resignation as chief minister and the dissolution of the Council of Ministers.

He asked Siddaramaiah to continue as caretaker Chief Minister until a new arrangement is decided.

In his letter to the Governor staking his claim, Shivakumar stated that the Karnataka CLP consisting of 135 members of the Indian National Congress, 2 associated members and 1 Raita Sangha MLA, had unanimously elected him as the Leader of the Congress Legislature Party.

Shivakumar previously served as the Deputy Chief Minister in the Siddaramaiah government.

Announcing Shivakumar's election as CLP leader, Karnataka Congress said, in a statement,

that Siddaramaiah proposed Shivakumar's name for the top position, G Parameshwara seconded the proposal, and the meeting unanimously endorsed it. Party general secretary (Organisation) KC Venugopal announced Shivakumar's election as the new CLP leader.

Later, speaking to reporters, Venugopal said under the guidance of AICC chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, a smooth transition of power took place in Karnataka.

He further said, "Under the leadership of Shivakumar, the Congress will return to power again with the support of Siddaramaiah in the 2028 assembly election in Karnataka." WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Asian Games

Among spinners, the frontline slow bowlers Kuldeep Yadav, Axar Patel, Washington Sundar and Harsh Dube have made it to the list, but only two of the four are expected to be picked.

The other two will play the Windies series.

Surprisingly, the only prominent non-performer to make the list is gold medal-winning skipper from the Hangzhou edition -- Ruturaj Gaikwad.

Longlist to IOA: Yashasvi Jaiswal, Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan, Sanju Samson (wk), Shreyas Iyer, Rishabh Pant (wk), Hardik Pandya, Rinku Singh, Tilak Varma, Jasprit Bumrah, Axar Patel, Arshdeep Singh, Kuldeep Yadav, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Prasidh Krishna, Varun Chakravarthy, Anukul Roy, Ayush Badoni, Harsh Dube, Dhruv Jurel, Khaleel Ahmed, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Ravi Bishnoi, Shahbaz Ahmed, Shivam Dube, Vipraj Nigam Nigam, Harshit Rana, Yash Thakur, Washington Sundar. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Back on mat

her comeback charge finally ran out of steam against Asian Championship silver medallist Meenakshi Goyat, bringing an emotional day to an abrupt end.

The day had begun dramatically even before she stepped on the mat.

Vinesh was initially informed during the official weigh-in that she would only be allowed to compete in the 50kg category, the division in which she had contested her last four international events, including the 2024 Paris Olympics.

The wrestler objected strongly and accused the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) of discrimination, prompting federation president Sanjay Singh to intervene and permit her entry into the 53kg trials.

After weighing 53.9kg, Vinesh entered the draw and opened her campaign with a comfortable 7-1 victory over Jyoti.

She then found herself staring at an early exit against the aggressive and technically proficient Nishu in a highly charged quarterfinal that swung between controversy and drama.

Nishu stunned Vinesh with a

spectacular four-point throw and almost secured a pin in the opening period to surge to a 5-0 lead. The bout was interrupted several times by challenges and technical glitches with the scoring system, resulting in lengthy stoppages.

Showing glimpses of the skill that made her one of India's most successful wrestlers, Vinesh fought back in the second period with a four-point throw that changed the complexion of the contest.

At one stage, Vinesh had almost pinned Nishu, prompting her husband Sombir Rathi and supporters to celebrate wildly and demand the victory 'by fall'. Following a challenge, officials ruled that the referee had blown the whistle incorrectly and wrestling resumed, denying Vinesh the pin.

She eventually edged the bout 7-6 after being ahead 6-6 on criteria as Nishu's final desperate attack failed and an unsuccessful challenge for a denied take-down handed Vinesh another point.

The emotionally draining contest, however, appeared to take a toll on Vinesh, whose lack of competitive wrestling in recent months was evident.

Against Meenakshi 3-2, thus avenging her defeat against the same opponent in the Asian Championship trials recently.

Meenakshi cried foul for biased refereeing. She argued with mat chairman when less than two seconds were left in the bout and was given a red card for her behaviour. She did not complete the bout and refused to leave the mat.

Earlier in the day, Vinesh had made her intentions clear when she told reporters: "I am here for at least two years."

The statement reflected her determination to continue wrestling despite the emotional scars of Paris Olympics, where she was disqualified from the women's 50kg final after being found overweight by a mere 100 grams on the morning of the gold-medal bout.

Saturday's trials were her first competitive appearance since that crushing setback and came amid a prolonged legal and administrative tussle with the WFI over her participation.

The Delhi High Court had recently directed the federation to treat Vinesh as an "iconic player" and allow her to compete in the Asian Games selection trials.

For a few hours on Saturday, the cheers from a packed hall suggested a fairytale return was possible. But by evening, Vinesh's comeback trail had hit another roadblock, leaving her to regroup and look ahead to the next chapter of her wrestling career.

While five other wrestlers got their places in the Indian team for the Asian Games, Vinesh remained the focus of the trials.

India's women's squad for Asian Games: Dipanshee (50kg), Antim Panghal (53kg), Manisha Bhanmawla (57kg), Mansi Ahlawat (62kg), Nisha Dahiyia (68kg) and Priyal Malik (76kg). PTI

‘ENABLING LARGE SCALE CORRUPTION’

Cong: Pradhan Mantri-Mantri Pradhan ‘jugalbandi’ destroying hopes of youth

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Saturday alleged that the “Pradhan Mantri-Mantri Pradhan jugalbandi” is destroying the hopes and aspirations of lakhs of youth across the country by “messaging up” the education system, encouraging the “infiltration of third-rate academics chosen by the RSS”, as well as enabling “large-scale corruption”.

The Opposition party’s attack came after the CUET-UG 2026 for admissions into undergraduate degree programmes across India was delayed at some centres on Saturday due to a technical glitch.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said, “After NEET and CBSE comes CUET. The Modi government is clearly in damage control mode. The Mantri Pradhan of course has been thoroughly discredited and



Students participate in a candle march and stage a demonstration over alleged exam paper leaks and examination irregularities in the Neet UG-2026 examination and Lekhpal recruitment process, in Prayagraj PTI

exposed for his incompetence, arrogance, and callousness.”

“He is beyond saving in public estimation, and even the cheerleaders and drum-beaters are ready to cut him loose,” Ramesh said in a jab targeted at Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

“They are now focused

on salvaging the image of the Pradhan Mantri - who has been absolutely silent and indifferent to the sufferings of millions of students, but is allegedly monitoring the situation closely,” Ramesh said.

Even now, the Modi government is only window-dressing and PR-managing,

Highlights

- » Opposition’s attack came after the CUET-UG 2026 for admissions into undergraduate degree programmes delayed at some centres on due to a technical glitch
- » ‘The use of the Indian armed forces to manage the logistics of the NEET-UG on June 21 is only an attempt to capitalise on their integrity & efficiency’

nications claimed.

It is clear that the NEET-UG paper leak this month happened at the level of the paper-setters and translators, not at the stage of question paper transportation, Ramesh claimed.

“The focus should be on disrupting the NTAs corrupt army of contractors and out-sourced staff - but the Modi government is letting them go scot-free because it is an open secret that most of them are politically connected to the RSS network,” the Congress leader alleged.

“The Pradhan Mantri-Mantri Pradhan jugalbandi is destroying the hopes and aspirations of lakhs of youth across the country. The duo has thoroughly messed up the education system, encouraged the infiltration of third-rate academics chosen by the RSS, and enabled large-scale corruption,” Ramesh claimed.

SP quietly finalises candidates for over half of UP seats

Signals tough bargaining ahead of alliance talks

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Takeaways

- » Party insiders said the leadership has given a green signal to candidates in constituencies where sitting legislators remain strong
- » The party has reportedly asked its state unit to identify strong candidates in 100 to 125 constituencies

LUCKNOW: Even as the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election is still months away and no party has officially announced candidates, the Samajwadi Party (SP) has quietly moved ahead with preparations by identifying and clearing contenders for a large number of constituencies.

According to senior party sources, SP has internally finalised candidates for more than half of the state’s 403 Assembly seats and directed them to begin groundwork in their respective constituencies.

The names have not been formally announced, but the selected leaders have been asked to intensify public outreach, strengthen booth-level networks and consolidate local caste and social equations.

Party insiders said the leadership has given a green signal to candidates in constituencies where sitting legislators remain strong, where SP narrowly lost

in the previous election, and where local surveys have identified winnable faces.

While the Election Commission’s announcement of the poll schedule will determine the formal release of candidates, the party has effectively begun preparations on the ground.

Political observers view the exercise as carrying another strategic objective. It comes at a time when SP and the Indian

National Congress are expected to begin negotiations over seat sharing for the 2027 Assembly election.

Following the Opposition alliance’s strong performance in Uttar Pradesh during the 2024 Lok Sabha election, Congress leaders are believed to be preparing a more aggressive claim for Assembly seats than in previous elections.

The party has reportedly asked its state unit to identify strong candidates in 100 to 125 constituencies and has instructed organisational units to remain active across all 403 seats as part of a contingency plan.

SP leaders, however, believe the party’s improved position after the Lok Sabha polls strengthens its claim to contest the overwhelming majority of seats. By identifying candidates early and activating them on the ground, the party is effectively marking territories where it considers itself the principal challenger to the BJP.

HIMACHAL PANCHAYAT POLLS

Women voters take lead as turnout hit 81% despite rain

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SHIMLA: Women emerged as the driving force in the final phase of Panchayat elections in Himachal Pradesh on Saturday, outnumbering men at polling booths across nine districts as overall turnout hit 81 per cent despite rain and stormy weather in several parts.

After casting his vote in his native Vijaypur village in Bilaspur district, Union Minister JP Nadda said he felt privileged to vote there and participate directly in the democratic process at the grassroots level.

Strength of democracy lies in the active participation of its citizens and democracy flourishes when people actively engage in decision-making through voting and civic participation, the former BJP national president said.

Women outpolled men in nine out of the state’s 12 districts, recording a turnout of 83.64 per cent against 77.77 per cent among male voters -- a gap of about six per cent.

Polling began at 7 am and concluded at 3 pm. The overall voter turnout was 81 per cent.

The highest turnout of 95 per cent was reported in Batgarh Gram Panchayat of Sirmaur’s Dadahu development block, followed by 84.66 per cent in Kullu, 83.84 per cent in Solan, 82.96 per cent in Shimla, 82.08 per cent in Mandi.

Chamba recorded 81.79 per cent voter turnout, Kinnaur 79.67, Una 78.60 per cent, Bilaspur 78.66 per cent, Kangra



An elderly voter shows her ink-marked finger after casting her vote, in Kullu district, Saturday PTI

77.29 per cent, and Hamirpur 76.52 per cent.

Lahaul and Spiti district recorded the lowest turnout at 71.05 per cent, according to official data. No untoward incident has been reported so far.

Election Officer Sanjeev Mahajan on Saturday said that a total of 15,40,324 voters were eligible to exercise their franchise across 1,189 Gram Panchayats.

The elections are being held through ballot papers and not on party symbols.

In the first phase, held on May 26, a voter turnout of 78.90 per cent was recorded across 1,293 Panchayats, while 79.88 per cent of voters cast their ballots in 1,276 Panchayats during the second phase on May 28.

A total of 10,854 office-bearers have already been elected unopposed.

Punjab govt clears regularisation framework for over 65,000 employees to end contractual system

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab Cabinet on Saturday delivered one of the most far-reaching pro-employee decisions in Punjab’s history, approving a roadmap to dismantle the decades-old contractual employment system and pave the way for the regularisation of more than 65,000 workers across government departments.

By ending the role of private contractors in government employment and creating a direct employer-employee relationship between the state and workers, the Bhagwant Mann government has moved to provide job security, dignity and a clear pathway to permanent service for thousands

Closer Look

- » Kejriwal said the Mann government has taken a historic decision that would restore rights, dignity and job security to thousands of workers and their families
- » Cabinet also approved two new ordinances to implement the transition, reconstituted a ministerial panel to address pending DA and pension-related dues

of employees who have spent years serving Punjab without regular status.

Hailing the move, AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal said the Bhagwant Mann government has taken a historic decision that would restore rights, dignity and job security to thousands of workers and their families.

The Cabinet also approved two new ordinances to imple-

ment the transition, reconstituted a ministerial panel to address pending Dearness Allowance (DA) and pension-related dues, and cleared the establishment of seven exclusive special courts for the speedy trial of corruption cases.

Sharing details of the decision, the Chief Minister’s Office stated that it has approved the repeal of the Punjab Adhoc, Contractual, Daily Wage, Tem-

porary, Work Charged and Outsourced Employees’ Welfare Act, 2016, and cleared the Punjab State Outsourced Personnel (Transition to Contractual Engagement) Bill, 2026 and the Punjab Contractual Personnel (Absorption Against Sanctioned Vacancies) Bill, 2026.

The move paves the way for bringing outsourced employees directly under the government and creating a clear pathway towards regular employment.

CM Mann stated, “More than 65,000 contract workers of Punjab have given the best years of their lives in the service of the state. With this decision, Punjab has returned to them what is rightfully theirs. No contractor will now stand between these employees and the state.”

Court orders framing of charges against Jacqueline, Sukesh for money laundering

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Saturday ordered framing of charges against actor Jacqueline Fernandez, alleged co-man Sukesh Chandrashekar and 15 others in a Rs 200-crore money laundering case.

The court also ordered framing of charges against Chandrashekar and 20 others for various offences, including under the stringent MCOCA provisions, in another case registered by the city police’s special cell.

In two separate orders, Additional Sessions Judge (ASJ) Prashant Sharma said that prima facie, there is suf-



Jacqueline Fernandez PTI

cient material against the accused.

In the ED case, ASJ Sharma said that the accused persons “have to be charged with the offence (of money laundering) under Section 3 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), punishable under Section 4 of the PMLA, the ASJ said.

In the case registered by the special cell and later probed by the economic offences wing, the judge ordered framing of charges against Chandrashekar for personating a public servant, extortion, cheating, criminal intimidation, criminal conspiracy, along with IT Act provisions and MCOCA sections for committing an organised crime and possessing unaccountable wealth on behalf of members of an organised crime syndicate.

He also ordered framing of similar charges, except for the offence of impersonating a public servant, against Chandrashekar’s wife, Leena Paulose.

J&K: Over 500 Agniveers inducted into Army after training

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SRINAGAR: A fresh batch of 540 Agniveers was on Saturday inducted into the Army after completing months of rigorous training here in Jammu and Kashmir.

An Attestation and Passing Out Parade was held at the Jammu and Kashmir Light Infantry (JAKLI) Regimental Centre in the outskirts of the city here, a defence spokesman said.

In a splendid display of military precision, discipline and patriotism, 540 Agniveers of the seventh batch successfully passed out from the Jammu and Kashmir Light Infantry Regimental Centre during an impressive attestation and passing out parade, he said.

Set against the majestic backdrop of the Kashmir Valley, the parade marked the transformation of young recruits into proud soldiers, ready to serve the nation with honour, courage and dedication, he said.

Punjab: RTI activist shot dead in Phagwara

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PHAGWARA: Jalandhar-based RTI activist Simaranjit Singh was shot dead by unidentified armed individuals near the gate of Maheru village under the Satnampura police station area on Saturday, police said.

Jalandhar Range DIG Naveen Singla said a 32 bore pistol was found near the body of Singh, while a 12 bore rifle was found in an SUV parked near the crime spot. He was shot from a close range in his head. “We are scanning CCTV footage and have formed multiple teams of police for tracing the assailants who will be arrested soon,” the DIG said, adding that if needed, help will be sought from counter intelligence for solving the murder case.

Singla, along with Kapurthala SSP Gaurav Toora, rushed to the spot after getting the information about the murder.

Police also recovered two mobile phones belonging to the victim near his body.

A case under relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita has been registered, the DIG added.

Singh, an advocate by profession, was known for filing RTIs and public interest litigation in the Punjab and Haryana High Court.

Last month, he had filed a plea, challenging the constitutional validity of the anti-sacrilige law -- Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Act, 2026.

His murder drew sharp reactions from the Opposition parties who targeted the AAP government over the law and order situation in the state.

Punjab Congress president Amrinder Singh Raja Warring condemned the killing of the activist and alleged that the law and order has completely collapsed in Punjab under the AAP government.

“Nobody, except the Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann is safe in Punjab today,” he said, while adding that Mann is safe only because of hundreds of cops protecting him round the clock. Warring pointed out, whether criminals or gangsters or terrorists, nobody has any fear of law in Punjab.

He said just a few days ago, an ASI was shot dead in Amritsar and the police still remain “clueless”.

PRAGATI 2026 EXPOSITION IN MEGHALAYA

India showcases indigenously developed defence technologies

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India showcased its indigenously developed defence technologies on Saturday as 52 companies demonstrated advanced military systems to senior military delegations from twelve nations at the inaugural PRAGATI 2026 exposition in Meghalaya.

Held at Foreign Training Node Umroi, Shillong, the two-day Defence Industry Equipment Display from 30th to 31st May was organised by FICCI in collaboration with Headquarters Eastern Command and the Army Design Bureau alongside the Multilateral Joint Exercise PRAGATI, Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region.

The exposition was inaugurated by Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth, Vice Chief of the Army Staff.

Participating nations included Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Seychelles, Sri Lanka, and



Vietnam, with defence attaches, procurement heads, and strategic stakeholders engaging directly with Indian industry across indoor and outdoor display areas.

Of the 52 participating organisations, 47 were from private-sector companies including MSMEs and start-ups alongside five Defence Public Sector Undertakings.

The exposition spanned UAVs and counter-UAV systems, secure communications, armament, autonomous and robotic systems, AI-enabled defence solutions, electronic warfare, cyber defence, and medical survivability equipment. Specific capabilities on display included loitering munition drones,

swarm technologies, anti-drone systems, artillery guns, robotic mules, unmanned ground and maritime vehicles, and ruggedised cyber-hardened platforms.

Structured as a Business-to-Government platform, the exposition enabled direct interaction between Indian industry representatives and senior military leaderships from partner nations. A dedicated networking reception with vice chiefs and senior delegates had been organised to facilitate strategic dialogue.

On the second day, engagement will extend to Central Armed Police Forces and state police organisations, broadening the scope to include homeland security requirements and internal security modernisation.

Nation Briefs

MP: SIX KILLED, 40 INJURED AS TRACTOR-TROLLEY OVERTURNS IN ANUPPUR

ANUPPUR: Six persons were killed, and 40 others sustained injuries after a tractor-trolley they were travelling in overturned in Madhya Pradesh’s Anuppur district, police said on Saturday. The accident occurred near Bijaura village, under the Karanpathar police station, on Friday evening, an official said. Around 50 people were travelling in the tractor-trolley when it overturned after the driver lost control, Additional Superintendent of Police Jagannath Markam said. The victims were travelling from Padmanica to Bijaura village for a puja, he said. Two persons died on the spot while four others succumbed to their injuries during treatment, the official said, adding that the injured were undergoing treatment at the Pali community health centre and the medical college in Umaria district.

J&K: TWO KILLED AS TRUCK FALLS INTO GORGE, CATCHES FIRE IN RAMBAN

JAMMU: Two people died after a truck plunged into a deep gorge and caught fire along the Jammu-Srinagar National Highway in Ramban district on Saturday, officials said. The accident took place near Gangroo in the Ramsao area. According to police, the truck carrying limestone was travelling from Jammu to Srinagar when the driver allegedly lost control of the vehicle near Gangroo. The truck rolled down the gorge and caught fire. Teams from Ramsao police station, the Himalayan Quick Response Team, the CRPF and Fire and Emergency Services reached the spot and launched a rescue operation.

The titanic challenge

RCB chase back-to-back IPL titles as Gill's Titans stand in their way

AHMEDABAD: In a fascinating battle of ideologies, the well-balanced and bold Royal Challengers Bengaluru will have to subdue a phlegmatic Gujarat Titans to lift their second consecutive IPL title here on Sunday.

On the paper, the reigning champions are the overwhelming favourites against the 2022 winners because of the fearless, high-risk game that they have been playing in this tournament so far.

It had landed them in trouble occasionally but Virat Kohli, Devdutt Padikkal, Tim David, skipper Rajat Patidar, Phil Salt, when available, and Venkatesh Iyer have relentlessly pounded the opposition with single-gear batting.

The nature of pitches or oppositions' bowling strategies have had little effect on their battering ram approach, and no other team has managed to go past 200 as often as they did in this edition of the IPL.

Patidar's calm approach to captaincy too has added to Royal Challengers' stability as a team across the last two seasons. He is not as evocative as former leaders Kohli or Faf du Plessis but there is a certain assuredness about the way the 32-year-old does his job, keeping both the superstars and



Virat Kohli gestures during a practice session

PTI

greenhorns in side at ease.

The RCB also have a stingy bowling unit, stifling the rival batters from the power play phase. But the Bhuvneshwar Kumar-led attack will have to be at their absolute best against the in-form Gujarat top-order.

In a tournament where the batters made optimum use of power play scoring over 11 or 12 runs an over, GT openers — skipper Shubhan Gill and Sai Sudharsan — have

been happy to maintain a run-rate just above 9. This linear build-up might be a conventional approach to Power Play, but it is partially because GT have a rather soft middle-order and the top three — Gill, Sudharsan and Jos Buttler need to do the heavy lifting. To their credit, Gill (722, strike-rate: 163), Sudharsan (710, SR: 159) and Buttler (507, SR: 157) have delivered almost consistently.

They will have to do the job

once again in the match that matters the most, and GT's home record this season—five wins in seven matches—offers a crumb of comfort as well.

It will be easier said than done as Bhuvneshwar, second in the Purple Cap list with 26 wickets, Josh Hazlewood (13 wickets), Rasikh Salam (16 wickets) and Krunal Pandya (13 wickets) have formed a wily and varied bowling attack for RCB. Not to forget, Pan-



GT have won five of the seven matches they have played so far in Ahmedabad this season

dya senior has also been very handy with the willow. But in that department the Titans have a slight upper hand.

The Royal Challengers' batting order gives them an undeniable edge because of its depth and the presence of range-hitters throughout.

But GT's bowling line-up has the wherewithal to stop the marauding RCB batters, particularly if the Ahmedabad pitch offers grip to them.

Kagiso Rabada, the current leader in the Purple Cap race with 28 wickets, Mohammad Siraj, Rashid Khan, Jason Holder, and Prasidh Krishna have given the South African strong support. Rabada and Siraj have struck an effective combine this season, bowling a chart-topping 165 and 162 dot balls respectively.

AGENCIES

PARIS: There will be a new men's champion at the French Open after Novak Djokovic followed Jannik Sinner out of Roland Garros in a five-set stunner on Friday.

Brazilian teenager Joao Fonseca beat 24-time major winner Djokovic 4-6, 4-6, 6-3, 7-5, 7-5 in the third round to follow Thursday's huge upset, when No. 1 Sinner — last year's runner-up lost to 56th-ranked Juan Manuel Cerundolo.

"Ten minutes after the match I could realize a little bit what I did, what I achieved," the 19-year-old Fonseca said. "How difficult it was and how amazing it was for me."

Djokovic's latest quest for a record 25th Grand Slam singles title was ended and it was just the second time he lost from two sets up, the other also coming in Paris in 2010.

Along with Daniil Medvedev, Marin Cilic and Stan Wawrinka, all the men's major winners are out, thus guaranteeing that a new pair of hands will raise the Coupe des Mousquetaires trophy aloft on June 7 on Court Philippe-Chatrier.

"Of course, Jannik and Djokovic out, there's more chances," said Fonseca, who next faces two-time runner-up Casper Ruud, who beat Tommy Paul 4-6, 6-7 (4), 6-4, 7-6 (4),



Novak Djokovic embraces Joao Fonseca after their match

AP

This wasn't as big an upset as Sinner's loss because Djokovic came to Paris with doubts

7-5.

Second-seeded Alexander Zverev, the 2024 runner-up, also advanced to the fourth round with a 6-4, 6-3, 5-7, 6-2 win late Friday over Frenchman Quentin Halys.

The 39-year-old Djokovic faded as the court slowed in the evening cool.

"Tough one for me to lose," Djokovic said. "I was barely standing on my legs toward

the end of the match."

Sabalenka on track

Aryna Sabalenka cut through the French Open chaos as the world No. 1 beat Australia's Daria Kasatkina 6-0 7-5 on Saturday to seal her place in the fourth round after seismic upsets.

With top seed Jannik Sinner and 24-times Grand Slam winner Novak Djokovic exiting in the last 48 hours, Sabalenka restored order with a commanding display to book a tantalising meeting with Japan's Naomi Osaka. "It has definitely been a great week," Sabalenka said during her on-court interview. "I'm happy to be through to the second week."

AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ali Hasan**, S/o: Mahandi Hasan, R/o: G-254, Gali No. 13/6, Bhagirathi Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 317/2023, U/s 25/54/59 A. Act & 102 Cr. P.C., P.S.: Gokal Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ali Hasan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ali Hasan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ali Hasan** accused of case **FIR No. 317/2023, U/s 25/54/59 A. Act & 102 Cr. P.C., P.S.: Gokal Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 02
Room No. 22, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/6945/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Tarun Chaudhary
Civil Judge (Junior Division)Hansi
Vikrant Goel S/o Agar Chand Goel
R/o H.No 636, Sector 6, HUDA, Hansi,
Teh. Hansi, Distt. Hissar for self and
Being GPA holder on behalf of his
real sister namely, Smt Rie Mohita D/o
Shri Agar Chand Goel (wife of Arun
Kumar Mohita)
Vs.
Chaudhary Tractors , Near Bhai Ji ka
Dhaba G T Road Hissar its Authorized
signatory Ms Anita Saini wife of
Late sh Ravinder Saini etc
Suit for mandatory inj to the effect
that plaintiff who is an accountant
work of defendant no. 1 firm owing
to which with passage of time there
were good terms and accordingly def
no. 1 firm through its partners i.e. Sh
Ravinder Saini and Smt Anita Saini
had borrowed a considerable huge
amount from the plaintiff on various
dates fully detailed in the body of
the plaint and agreed to return the
same in the near future but when the
same was not returned a panchayat
was convened in which ultimately
the defendant no. 1 firm had agreed
to return the amount Rupees Twenty
lacs to the plaintiff but later on had
failed to do so regarding which later
on a cheque was issued by def no. 1
firm but the same was dishonoured
regarding which a separate complaint
was filed against def no. 1 firm and
sh Ravinder Saini but sh Ravinder
Saini had expired leaving behind his
legal hires i.e. defendanta no. 2 to 5
who are equally and lawfully bound
to make payment of the said amount
of rupees twenty lacs alongwith
interest at the rate of 18 per cent
per annum from 25.12.2021 till
its actual payment alongwith costs
of litigation of the present suit and
for attachment and auction of the
movable and immovable properties
of the defendants including Saini motors
A Hero motorco vehicle dealership
located on G T Road Hissar under
the provisions of order 38 rule 5 read
with order 39 rule 1 and 2 CPC till making
payment of the said amount to the
plaintiff on the basis of evidence of
all kinds oral as well as documentary
of every description.

CNR No. HRS5AO-001245-2024
Next Date:- 22-10-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
1 Chaudhary Tractors Near Bhaiji Ka
Dhaba, G.T. Road, Hissar through its
Authorized Signatory Ms. Anita Saini
W/o Late Ravinder Saini 4. Harsha
Saini D/o Late sh Ravinder Saini 5.
Sonam D/o Late sh Ravinder Saini
both C/o Saini Motors Opposite Bhai Ji
ka dhaba Near Hissar Chugri G T Road
Hansi distt Hissar
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/
respondent(s) could not be served. It
is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s)
should appear in person or through
counsel on 22.10.2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/tmod> = district
notice & district = Hissar
Sd/- Sh. Tarun Chaudhary
Civil Judge
(Junior Division)
Dated this day of 30.05.2026 Hansi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused
person **Nanhe** S/o Sh. Ompal R/o Gali No. 40, Madhu Vihar,
Raja Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have
committed) the offence case FIR No. 479/2021 u/s
427/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi and it has
been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that
the said **Nanhe** cannot be found and whereas it has been
shown to my satisfaction that the said **Nanhe** has
absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of
the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been
initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the
said **Nanhe** accused of FIR No. 479/2021 u/s
427/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi is
required to appear before this Court to answer the said
complaint on 01.07.2026.
By Order: **Ms. Moksha Bains**,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II, (West),
Room No. 31,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7164/WD/2026

AXIS BANK

Branch Office - Axis Bank Limited, SBB Loan Center-SCO-221, 2nd Floor, Paramjeet
Tower, Sector-12, Karnal-132001 Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, Block-B, Bombay
Trishuli Mills Compound, Pandurang Budhakar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400 025 Registered Office:
Teyling, 3rd floor, opposite Samaratheswar Temple, Law garden, Ellsbridge, Ahmedabad-380006

Demand Notice u/s 13(2) of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and
Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002

Whereas the borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors mentioned hereunder had availed the
financial assistance from Axis Bank Ltd. We state that despite having availed the financial assistance, the
borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors have committed various defaults in repayment of interest and principal
amounts as per due dates. The account has been classified as Non-Performing Asset on the respective
dates mentioned hereunder in accordance with the directives/guidelines issued by Reserve Bank of India,
consequent to the Authorized Officer of Axis Bank Ltd. under Securitization and Reconstruction of
Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 & in exercise of powers conferred under
Section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 Issued Demand. Notices on
respective dates mentioned herein below under Section 13(2) of SARFAESI Act, 2002 calling upon the
following borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors to repay the amount mentioned in the notices together with
further interest at the contractual rate on the amount mentioned in the notices and incidental expenses,
cost, charges etc. until the date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of notices. The
notices issued to them on their last known addresses have returned un-served and as such they are
hereby informed by way of public notice on the date of the same.

Name of Co-borrower and Guarantor Name / Address: 1. M/s R K Trading Company Through Its
Prop.-Mr. Rukmudin S/o Mr. Niyaz Mohamad Running At-Vill: Uttawar Hathin, Hodal Road, Distt-Palwak-
121103 Haryana 1. Mr. Rukmudin S/o Mr. Niyaz Mohamad R/o H.No-33, Pingawar, Mewal -122508
Haryana 2. Mrs. Rukseena W/o Mr. Rukm R/o H.No-33, Ward No-1, Near Masjid, Palu Colony,
Pingawar, Mewal-122508 Haryana Property Address of Secured Assets: 1. All Piece & Parcels of
Residential Property measuring 360 Sq. Yds. i.e 12 Marla, 12/128 Share out of 6 Kanal 8 Marla i.e 12
Marla, Comprised in Khewat/Khata No- 1052/1098, Mustil No- 32, Kila No- 23/16-8) Situated at-Vill-
Pingawar, Tehsil- Punharna, Distt- Mewat Nuh Haryana owned by Mrs. Rukseena vide Sale Deed
bearing Registration No. 460 Dated 15-MAY-2015. Boundaries: North - As Per Deed. South - As Per
Deed. East-As Per Deed. West-as Per Deed

NPA Date
28-OCT-2026

Date of Demand Notice
04-APR-2026

Loan Amount: Rs. 25,00,00,00/-
(Rupees Twenty Five Lakhs Only)

Outstanding Amount: Rs. 25,36,412.49/- (Rupees Twenty Five Lakhs Thirty Six Thousand Four
Hundred Twelve And Forty Nine Paise Only)

Name of Co-borrower and Guarantor Name / Address: 1. M/s Mursaleem Khan Enterprises
Through Its Prop.-Mr. Mursalm S/o Mr. Harun @ Haroon Running At- Near By Jain Bhatta Uttawar
Hathin, Palwak, Faridabad, Distt-Palwak-121103 Haryana 1. Mr. Mursalm S/o Mr. Harun @ Haroon R/o
Vill- Mathepur Majra, Chhainsa, Hathin Distt- Palwak-121103 Haryana Property Address of Secured
Assets: 1. All that part and parcel of the Non-Agri Property Measuring 605 Sq. Yds., Comprised in
Khatas Nos- 765, Must. No- 149, Kila No- 12/21 (0-14), 19/11/14 (0-6) Situated at- Waka
Mouja Uttawar, Tehsil- Hathin, Distt- Palwak Haryana Owned by Mr. Mursalm vide Transfer deed no-
2976 Dated: 15-DEC-2023. Boundaries: North-Road, South-Property of Gore Khan, East-Property of
Manisha, West-Property of Jan Mohd.

NPA Date
21-OCT-2025

Date of Demand Notice
04-APR-2026

Loan Amount:
Rs. 20,00,00,00/- (Rupees Twenty Lakhs Only)

Outstanding Amount: Rs. 20,42,302.32/- (Rupees Twenty Lakhs Forty Two Thousand Three Hundred
Two And Thirty Two Paise Only)

In the circumstances as aforesaid, the notice is hereby given to the above borrowers, co-borrowers and/
or their guarantors (where ever applicable) to pay the outstanding dues as mentioned above along with
future interest and applicable charges within 60 days from the date of the publication of this notice failing
which further steps will be taken after the expiry of 60 days of the date of this notice against the secured
assets including taking possession of the secured assets, of the borrowers and the mortgagors under
Section 13(4) of Securitization and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security
Interest Act, 2002 and the applicable rules thereunder. Please note that under Section 13 (13) of the
said Act, no Borrower shall, transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise any of his secured assets
referred to in the notice, without prior written consent of the secured creditor.

Place: Karnal, Date: 31.05.2026

-SD/-Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hissar
MEHAR DHAMJIA MINOR
THROUGH HER FATHER VIKRANT
DHAMJIA
Vs.
REGISTRAR BIRTHS AND DEATHS
SUIT FOR DECLARATION to the effect
that the name of the mother of the
plaintiff recorded as Manvi Dhamjia
in the birth recorded /birth certificate
of the plaintiff bearing registration no.
6897 dated 28.08.2012 maintained
CNR No. HRS02-001267-2026
Next Date:- 10-07-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
Hissar.
In above titled case, the defendant
(s)/respondent(s) could not be served.
It is ordered that defendant(s)/
respondent(s) should appear in person
or through counsel on 10-07-2026 at
10:00 am.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/tmod> = district
notice & district = Hissar
Sd/- Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Dated 21-05-2026 Hissar,

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

e-tender Notice No. 18 of 2026-27 (Open)
Engg/DDU
On/Line (through e-tendering) for the
following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU
for and on behalf of the President of India
from experienced and financially as well as
technically sound contractors including
those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD,
BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector
undertakings.
Tender No.: 14-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27
Name of work with its location : Renovation
of Railway Inter College in PD Colony at
DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. Advertised
Value : ₹4,40,86,459.02, Earnest Money :
₹8,81,700/-
Name of work : 15-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27
Name of work with its location : Manpur - Pt.
Deen Dayal Upadhyaya - Cess Repair Work
-17.66 TkM (6m 16.26 TkM & 3m -1.4 TkM).
Advertised Value : ₹8,15,13,086.82.
Earnest Money: ₹16,30,300/-
Tender No. : 16-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27
Name of work with its location : Construction
of boundary wall/compound wall at
vulnerable locations around the colonies at
Gaya. Advertised Value : ₹1,12,32,959.70.
Earnest Money: ₹2,24,700/-
Closing Date & time for submission of e-
tender:18.06.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. Website
particulars of e-tendering: www.ireps.gov.in
Divisional Railway Manager/
ECR/PL Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/0325/DDU/Engg/T/26-27/44

India share spoils in Oz

PERTH: The Indian women's
hockey team lost 2-3 against
hosts Australia to share the
four-match friendly series 2-2
here on Saturday.
India came out strongly
in the contest, taking a 1-0
lead in just the second min-
ute when Navneet Kaur con-
verted a penalty corner to put
early pressure on Australia.
In the second quarter,
Deepika Soreng (23th) dou-
bled India's lead with a neat
conversion. It remained 2-0
at half-time. Australia fought
back in the third quarter, lev-
elling through strikes from
Abby Wilson (42nd) and
Olivia Downes (44th) in quick
succession. A late strike from
Courtney Schonell (58th) gave
the hosts a narrow 3-2 win.
Despite the result, India can
take plenty of positives from
the tour.
Having bounced back
from an opening-game defeat
to win the next two matches,
the Indian team demonstrated
resilience, tactical discipline
and a potent attacking threat
throughout the series, con-
tinuing to build ahead of the
upcoming season that begins
with the Nations Cup. AGENCIES

COURT NOTICE
U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Navjeet Klair
Additional District and Sessions
Judge-II, Sirsa
KALA DEVI
Vs.
GHISA RAM
CNR No. HRS101-008949-2025
Next Date: 24-07-2026
CA-217-2025
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
RES. 3-SANTOSH D/O DHANNI
S/O DHOPA RESIDENT OF VILLAGE
PANTAWAS TEHSIL AND DISTT CHARKHI
DADRI
RES. 4-DILAWAR SINGH S/O DHANNI
S/O DHOPA
RES. 5-SAJJAN KUMAR S/O SMT.
MATHRI D/O DHAPAN
RES.6-JAG PARVESH S/O SMT. MATHRI
D/O DHAPAN
RES.7-NARESH S/O SMT. MATHRI D/O
DHAPAN
RES.8-JAGJEET S/O SMT. MATHRI D/O
DHAPAN
RES.9-KRISHNA DEVI S/O SMT. MATHRI
D/O DHAPAN
RES.10-SALOCHANA S/O SMT. MATHRI
D/O DHAPAN
RES.11-HARPAL DEVI WIDOW OF
DAWARKA PARSHAD S/O MATHRI
RES.12-VINOD S/O DAWARKA
PARSHAD S/O MATHRI
RES.13-MANOJ S/O DAWARKA
PARSHAD S/O MATHRI
RES.14-USHA D/O DAWARKA PARSHAD
S/O MATHRI, ALL R/O VILLAGE NIYOLI
KHURD, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT HISSAR
In above titled case, the defendant(s)
respondent(s) could not be served. It is
ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s)
should appear in person or through counsel
on 24-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/tmod> = district notice & district = Sirsa
Sd/-Ms. Navjeet Klair
Additional District and
Sessions Judge-II, Sirsa
dated 27.05.2026

Liverpool sack Slot after dismal season

BUDAPEST: Liverpool fired
manager Arne Slot on Satur-
day following a troubled sec-
ond season in charge having
previously led the team to the
Premier League title.
Fenway Sports Group, the
club's American ownership,
said it made a "difficult" de-
cision after Liverpool finished
fifth in a disappointing title
defense. "We have collectively
come to the conclusion that
change is necessary in order
for the club to keep moving for-
ward," the ownership said in a
statement. "Again, it must be
stressed that this is not a de-
cision which has been reached
lightly, anything but."
Slot replaced popular long-
time manager Jurgen Klopp in
the summer of 2024 and the
Dutchman led Liverpool to a
record-tying 20th English
league title in his first year at
the helm. Liverpool spent an
unprecedented \$570 million
to strength the squad last year
but most of the expensive sign-
ings, including Florian Wirtz
and Alexander Isak, have
underwhelmed. AGENCIES

KEEPS PRESSURE AT BAY Advantage GT? Gill backs team to hit a home run

Shubman Gill bats at nets

PTI

AHMEDABAD: Standing on the cusp of his first IPL title as captain, Shubman Gill said he does not get burdened by expectations but hoped to leverage Gujarat Titans' home advantage in the final against Royal Challengers Bengaluru.

Both GT and defending champions RCB are seeking their respective second IPL title at the sprawling Narendra Modi Stadium here on Sunday.

"Honestly, I don't really get the burden of expectations. There are advantages, there's familiarity when we play here, as we know the wicket, the ground

match that they lost by a massive margin of 92 runs. So, are they wary of the fatigue factor after shuttling around the venues ahead of the final? For Gill, it was all about mindset. "Dharamsala is kind of a difficult venue to, you know, get there and travel. But, yes, physically they (RCB) might have an advantage. But I think finals are all about mental, so the team that is mentally up there for the challenge is the one that's going to win," he added.

While most of the teams adopted an explosive batting method from the word go, GT trusted in a rather old-school approach of keeping wickets in hand upfront and gradual acceleration. "I think it's all about getting the job done, isn't it?" he said.

AGENCIES

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

TENDER NOTICE No. ELG-02-M05-2026-27

Date : 26.05.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N. C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works:

Tender No. : ELG-02-M05-2026-27

Approx. Cost of the work : Rs.12407540.65

Name of work with its location & Completion Period : Agra cantt-Provision of Packaged type Substation and Strengthening work of various sub-station under SSE/P&AGC jurisdiction.

Completion period : 08 months

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on 24-06-2026. 1211/26 (C)

 North central railways

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

 ncr@CPRONCR

**UJVN LIMITED**

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006, Telephone:- 0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508

CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Ref. No.: 463

e-Tender Notice

Dated : 30.05.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Hat, Pithoragarh invites online bids for construction of Tankul SHP (3x4 MW) from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No - 03/EE(Civil-SHP)/Dharchula/2026-27

Name of Work :- Construction of trench weir, power intake including river diversion arrangements, desilting tank, feeder pipe, tunnel, surge shaft, power house, hydro mechanical works of Tankul SHP (3 x 4 MW) on river simkhologad at tehsil Dharchula in dist. Pithoragarh of Uttarakhand.

Estimated cost : Rs. 87.90 Crore (including GST)

Date of availability of bid document on website : 10-06-2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of tender : 10-07-2026 up to 17:00 Hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal www.uktenders.gov.in

Executive Engineer

(Civil-SHP),

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Karan A. Chanana, Amitra Pure Foods Pvt. Ltd., B-1/E28, Mohan Cooperative Industrial Estate, New Delhi-14 at Plot No. 54, MG Road Prakarli Marg, Near Sultanpur Farm, Mehrauli, Delhi-30** also at **First Floor, Hotel Clarion Collections, Shahid Jeet Singh Marg, Delhi-16** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Case No. 528514/2016, 528516/2016, 528515/2016, 527504/2016, 527505/2016, 528172/2016 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Lahori Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Karan A. Chanana** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Karan A. Chanana** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Karan A. Chanana of Case No. 528514/2016, 528516/2016, 528515/2016, 527504/2016, 527505/2016, 528172/2016 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Lahori Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **01.07.2026**

By Order,

Ms. Urvi Gupta

Judicial Magistrate First Class(NI Act-01)

Central District, Room No. 201, Annexe-II

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7065/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Manish Kumar S/o Rajesh R/o H.No. H-534, JJ Colony, Shakur Pur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 155/2021 U/s 380/382/ 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act at PS: Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Manish Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manish Kumar of FIR No. 155/2021 U/s 380/382 /411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act of PS: Subhash Place, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.07.2026**.

By order

Upasana Satija

Chief Judicial Magistrate

North-West, Room No.108, 1st Floor,

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/5175/NW/2026

**UJVN LIMITED**

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Telephones:- 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508

CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 462

Tender Notice

Date: 30/05/2026

Office of Executive Engineer (M) Ramganga Power Station, UJVN Limited, Kalagarh, Distt. Pauri Garhwal invites sealed tender from interested parties. Details of tenders is given below:

Tender No. _____ **Name of work/supply** _____

T.N.No: 07/EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Annual Maintenance of Unit no. 1.

T.N.No: 08/EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Repairing and O/H of brake-jack pads of Unit#1 & 3.

T.N.No: 09/EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Repairing and O/H of LOP pump & LOP motors and external oil coolers of Unit#1 & 3.

T.N.No: 10 /EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Repair and Overhauling of 02 Nos. Draft Tube Gates of Unit no. 03 and 20 Ton Gantry Crane.

Estimated cost : Rs.24,70,000.00, Rs.6,15,300.00, Rs.4,02,000.00 & Rs.20,75,000.00 Only respectively (GST extra)

Date of Availability of bid document on website : 30.05.2026 10:00 Hrs.

Last date for submission of tender : 20.06.2026 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (M)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi Thapa, S/o Lt. Sh. Rakesh Thapa R/o H.No.24, Gali No.10, C-Block, Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.357/2020 u/s 12/9/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi Thapa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi Thapa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi Thapa of FIR No.357/2020 u/s 12/9/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.07.2026**.

By Order,

Ms. Preeti Rajoria

Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-07

Room No.32, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7060/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Rohit Mundwal S/o Rama Shankar Mundwal R/o Gym Wali Gali, Nihal Vihar, New Delhi, Outer District, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR NO. 67/21 U/S 356/379/34 IPC PS: Nihal Vihar, New Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rohit Mundwal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rohit Mundwal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rohit Mundwal** accused of **FIR NO. 67/21 U/S 356/379/34 IPC PS: Nihal Vihar, New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.07.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Komal Garg

DP/7103/OD/2026 JMFC-03, Room No. 292, West District,

(Court Matter) Tis Haszari Courts, Delhi

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd. 4/10, Mythree Tower, Bommanhalli Hosur Main Road Bangalore- 560068

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Vellatturi Sudhakar/ Vellatturi Subalakshmi/ LBTEN00005198416	Schedule of The Property Guntur District, Tenali West Sub District, Angalakuduru Grama Panchayath Area In Angalakuduru Village D. No. 322/3, 322/4 In Two D. Numbers Land Is Contiguous and as Per Plan Plot No. 1 Site Is Bounded By: East : Plot No. 8 Site -30'-09". South:18 Ft. Wide Panchayath Road 30-06". West:18 Ft. Wide Panchayath Road -30'-09", North: Plot No. 2 Site Of Unmudi Lakshmi - 31'-09", I Within These Boundaries An Extent Of 106.34 Sq. Yds. Or 88.91 Sq. Mts. And In That Ground Floor, R C C Daba And With All Other Amenities Along With All Access Rights And Easementary Rights. Property With Door No. 5-136, Panchayath Assessment No. 824 Current Service Connection No. 1211651000796/ Symbolic Possession On/26/05/2026.	20.12.2025 Rs. 26,69,354.60/-	Tenali

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: May 31, 2026, Place: Gurgaon

Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir**

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY (JKRRDA) JAMMU.

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS

821 of 2026-27 Dated:- 26/05/2026

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu on behalf of The Government of Jammu & Kashmir, invites e-tenders on %age Above/Excess (+) OR %age Below/ Less (-) basis (i.e. on Percentage-Rate Basis) from approved and eligible Contractors registered with J&K U.T.Govt, CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State/U.T.Govts up to 1700 Hrs. on 19-06-2026 for each of the following works.

Sr. No.	Name of Work/ Package No.	Name of the PIU	Const. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Maint. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Total (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Documents (Rs. In Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) @2% of total cost rounded to the nearest thousand (Rs. In Lacs)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of technical bids	Class of Contractor
1	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L617-(Link Road) Balmakote to Bogudies Km 8 PMGSY Road to Okrapan Package No. JK20-4216, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Mahore, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 8.500 Kms) Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 2072.29 Lacs	Mahore	2072.29	165.78	2238.07	0.20	44.76	20 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
2	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L619-(Link Road) BMG road - Tramlia to Ghoragali Package No. JK20-4204, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Mahore, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 10.000 Kms) Length 10.000 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 2338.89 Lacs	Mahore	2338.89	187.11	2526.00	0.20	50.52	21 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
3	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L137-pwd road Pannasgandali to Blada Package No. JK20-4264, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thakrakote, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 5.500 Kms) Length 8.000 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1792.37 Lacs	Mahore	1792.37	143.38	1935.75	0.20	38.72	18 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
4	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L141-PMGSY Road Mori Dhakikote to Chhandi Package No. JK20-4277, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thakrakote, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 6.650 Kms) Length 9.950 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 2120.84 Lacs	Mahore	2120.84	169.66	2290.50	0.20	45.81	20 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
5	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L154-(Link road) Budhan-Gref Road to Hiramangal Package No. JK20-4245, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thakrakote, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 4.200 Kms) Length 4.200 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 990.63 Lacs	Mahore	990.63	79.25	1069.88	0.20	21.40	15 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
6	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L060-(Link road) Gref road Reasi to Mahore KM 45th to Daman Package No. JK20-4270, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thuroo, District Reasi. (Using Open Graded Premix Carpet (OGPC) 4.800 Kms) Length 4.800 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1109.59 Lacs	Mahore	1109.59	88.76	1198.35	0.20	23.97	15 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
7	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L061-(Link road) Gund to Judda Km 5th PMGSY Road to DaddarJullamasta Package No. JK20-4284, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thuroo, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 6.000 Kms) Length 8.500 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 2004.47 Lacs	Mahore	2004.47	160.35	2164.82	0.20	43.30	20 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
8	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L156-(Link road) KM 6th BudhanThuroo Back to Kotekatha Package No. JK20-4246, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thuroo, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 12.500 Kms) Length 12.500 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 3044.66 Lacs	Mahore	3044.66	243.57	3288.23	0.20	65.76	25 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
9	of Road from L079-(Link road) Budhan Lancha KM 4th PMGSY Road to Hill Package No. JK20-4249, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thuroo, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 6.450 Kms) Length 6.450 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1554.41 Lacs	Mahore	1554.41	124.35	1678.76	0.20	33.58	17 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
10	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L151-(Link road) BudhanLancha KM 7th PMGSY Road to Bakwala Package No. JK20-4247, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thuroo, District Reasi. (Using Waste Plastics 10.000 Kms) Length 10.000 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 2494.10 Lacs	Mahore	2494.10	199.52	2693.62	0.20	53.87	22 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
11	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L075-(Link road) L031-Bari Darhal road to Budhkhandari via Gandainwali Package No. JK12-4561, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Darhal, District Rajouri. Length 7.000 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1551.04 Lacs	Budhal	1551.04	124.08	1675.12	0.20	33.50	17 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
12	Construction and Maintenance of Road L056-Link from Prayali Katha Chauri to Galla Jabri (Ratanpir) Package No. JK12-4596, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thanamandi, District Rajouri Length 4.000Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 850.30 Lacs	Budhal	850.30	68.02	918.32	0.10	18.37	11 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
13	Construction and Maintenance of Road L047-(Link Road) Matyala to Gala Kurkwar (Ratan Peer) Package No. JK12-4545, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thanamandi, District Rajouri (Using Waste Plastics Length 6.500 Kms) Length 6.500Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1436.57 Lacs	Budhal	1436.57	114.92	1551.49	0.20	31.03	16 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
14	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L076-(Link road) Dodaj main road Patyarni to Patyarni Package No. JK12-4566, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Darhal, District Rajouri. Length 4.200 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 916.36 Lacs	Budhal	916.36	73.30	989.66	0.20	19.79	12 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
15	Construction and Maintenance of Road from L080-(Link road) Dodaj main road to Rossi wala Package No. JK12-4557, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Darhal, District Rajouri. Length 4.700 Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1043.96 Lacs	Budhal	1043.96	83.51	1127.47	0.20	22.55	15 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works
16	Construction and Maintenance of Road L040-Link from KM 9th of Hasplate-Pangal road to Thakra Package No. JK12-4544, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Thanamandi, District Rajouri Length 5.000Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1092.10 Lacs	Budhal	1092.10	87.36	1179.46	0.10	23.59	15 months	1 st	22-06-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works

Date and Time Schedule

S.No	Particulars	Date	Time
1	Date of issue of tender notice	29.05.2026	1700 hrs
2	Document Download / Sale Start Date	29.05.2026	1855 hrs
3	Pre-Bid Meeting	01.06.2026	1200 hrs
4	Bid submission start date	02.06.2026	1000 hrs
5	Bid submission end date	19.06.2026	1700 hrs
6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	22.06.2026	1100 hrs
7	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed

1. The bidding document can be downloaded from the website and bids shall be submitted ONLINE ONLY in electronic format through the e-tendering portal.

2. For complete details and instructions, bidders are advised to refer to Standard bidding document(SBD).

3. For further details and updates, bidders may visit the official website <https://pmgsytenders.jk.gov.in>.

Dated:-26-05-2026

DIP/J-2889/26

Sd/-

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu

For and on behalf of The Government of Jammu and Kashmir

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER P.W.D UJJAIN ZONE UJJAIN

No 0734-2524462 E-Mail cepwdujjain@mp.nic.in

Tender Notice

UJJAIN DATE 26-05-2026

ONLINE PERCENTAGE RATE TENDER FOR THE WORK MENTIONED BELOW ARE BEING INVITED. THE TENDER HAS/HAVE BEEN UPLOADED ON THE E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM OF PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT ON THE PORTAL WWW.MPTENDERS.GOV.IN TENDER DETAILS ARE AS BELOW:-

S. No.	Division Name	Tender ID No.	Name of work	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. In lacs)	Time Period
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	UJJAIN	2026_PWDRB_510868_1	TAPOBHUMI TO GANGEDI VIA RAGHOPIPLIYA ROAD	1866.09	12 Months Including Rainy Season

THE DOCUMENT CAN ONLY BE PURCHASED ONLINE FROM THE ABOVE WEBSITE AFTER MAKING ONLINE PAYMENT. THE LAST DATE & TIME FOR PURCHASE OF DOCUMENT AND ONLINE BID SUBMISSION ON LINE IS DATED 10-06-2026 UP TO 17:30 PM. DETAILED NIT AND OTHER DETAILS CAN BE VIEWED ON THE ABOVE MENTIONED PORTAL. AMENDMENTS TO NIT, IF ANY, WOULD BE PUBLISHED ON WEBSITE ONLY, AND NOT IN NEWSPAPER.

G13680/26

CHIEF ENGINEER

P.W.D UJJAIN ZONE UJJAIN

"स्वाभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता"

CORPORATE MERCHANT BANKERS LIMITED

CIN : L74899DL1994PLC061107

Registered Address : A-19, Ground Floor, Okhla Phase-2, FIEE Complex, Kartar Tower, Okhla Industrial Estate, South Delhi, Delhi-110020.

Extract of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Year ended 31/03/2026

(Rs. In Lakhs except EPS)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ending 31/03/2026	Year to Date Figures 31/03/2026	Corresponding Three Months Ended in the Previous Year 31.03.2025
1	Total Income	175.90	662.91	297.36
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	44.19	332.61	280.93
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	44.19	332.61	280.93
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	33.14	244.46	211.01
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	33.14	244.46	211.01
6	Equity Share Capital	6340.41	6340.14	330.00
7	Reserves & Surplus (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year	-----	4097.56	-----
8	Face Value of Equity Share Capital	10/-	10/-	10/-
9	Earnings Per Share (Basic / Diluted)	0.05	0.39	6.39

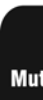
Note: The above is an extract of the detailed form of Quarterly and Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015. The full form of the Quarterly and Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites i.e. www.bseindia.com and www.mseil.in

Date : 29/05/2026

Place : Ahmedabad

For, Corporate Merchant Bankers Limited

Sd/- Vishal Jehlalal Nayak - Managing Director • DIN:11048209

**Muthoot Homefin**

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

CIN: U65922XK2014PLC029231

Corporate Office: Muthoot Homefin (INDIA) Ltd. 19/E, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Tuli Pipe Road, Near Ruparel College, Dadar West, Mumbai - 400028.

Branch Office: Muthoot Homefin India Ltd. B-12, First Floor, Tagore Market, Kirti Nagar Near by Ramesh Nagar, Opposite Metro Pillor No 335 New Delhi- 110015

APPENDIX-IV-A [See proviso to Rule 8(6)]

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR AUCTION CUM SALE

Pursuant to taking possession of the secured asset mentioned hereunder by the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 for the recovery of amount due from borrower/s, offers are invited by the undersigned in sealed covers for purchase of immovable property, as described hereunder, which is in the possession, on 'As Is Where Is Basis', 'As Is What Is Basis' and 'Whatever Is There Is Basis', Particulars of which are given below:-

Sr. No.	Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) / Loan Account No. / Branch	Demand Notice Date and Amount	Description of the Immovable property	Reserve Price	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (10% of RP)
1.	Shahanawaz/ Bano/- DEL-HL-000631/ Delhi	21-Jul-25/ Rs. 20,71,717/- Rupees Twenty Lakh Seventy One Thousand Seven Hundred Seventeen Only.	Flat No FF-1 on First Floor Rhr Flat Aakash Vihar Village Sadullabad Pergana & Tehsil-Loni District- Ghaziabad State-Uttar Pradesh Pincode- 201102 Boundaries East-Road 30ft Wide, West- Entry, North- Part of Plot, South- Frant L.H.S Flat	Rs. 15,04,800/- Rupees Fifteen Lakh Four Thousand Eight Hundred Only.	Rs. 1,50,480/- Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand Four Hundred Eighty Only.

1. The Auction is being held on "AS IS WHERE IS" AND "AS IS WHAT IS" basis

2. The detailed terms and conditions of the auction sale are incorporated in the prescribed tender form, available at the above mentioned regional office

3. Last Date of Submission



In the late nineteenth-century fiction of Bankim-chandra Chattopadhyay, *Muchiram Gurer Jibon-charit*, Muchiram tries his luck at securing a job in the British Collectorate. Many learned Bengalis, fluent in English, had also applied for the same post. Yet the Colonial Sahib dismissed all of them saying, “It is not the learned man who is fitted for this job, so you can go, babu.” Muchiram got the job because the job of receiving petitions from peasants in the courtroom or collecting land revenue did not require a highly educated person.

This story comes to mind when one thinks about the current state of India’s labour market. According to the Economic Survey 2024–25, only 8.25 per cent of Indian graduates are employed in “high competency” skilled occupations classified as matching their graduate-level skills, while more than half are in elementary or semi-skilled jobs, indicating working below their potential.

In many cases, young people fail to get jobs because they are overeducated for the available work. When they do find employment, in many cases their university education proves to be of little practical use. Each year, millions of graduates and post-graduates enter India’s labour market, but the creation of suitable graduate-level employment has not kept pace with the workforce supply.

The question is: why are our youngsters unable to put their university education to use in the labour market? I am not speaking here of technical education, although the same problem of skill mismatch exists there as well. My focus is on general undergraduate and postgraduate education.

EMERGING ISSUES

Is the problem one of labour demand or labour supply? From the demand side, employers are seeking workers who have the skills to perform the job. From the supply side, many argue that university education is excessively theoretical. Students do not acquire marketable skills. As a result, they are unable to present themselves effectively in the labour market. Therefore, the university curriculum needs radical reforms. For example, instead of overloading the curricula with teaching Milton, Byron, or Rabindranath in literature courses, universities should introduce core courses on how to write feature articles. In mathematics and economics departments, students should be trained to handle big data. At the same time, courses should be introduced to prepare students to work with artificial

intelligence. Many universities in India and abroad are already moving along these lines.

MARKET-ORIENTED EDUCATION

Although there is a growing trend for market-oriented education, there is a problem with this line of thinking. Once a syllabus begins to move in a market-oriented direction, it may become difficult to arrest that flow. Many university teachers may not have the experience or even the inclination to provide this kind of practical training. A distinguished professor of English may teach Tennyson’s poetry with dedication and passion, but may not feel the same enthusiasm for teaching students how to write popular journalistic articles.

INDIA RISKS CONTINUING TO PRODUCE DEGREES WITHOUT DIRECTION AND ASPIRATIONS WITHOUT OPPORTUNITY

Thus, the problem of skill match in the labour market remains unresolved. An employer has the responsibility to find the right match of workers for the job in his business. By interviewing a university graduate, a perceptive manager should be able to understand how her/his talents should be used. A philosophy graduate with leadership potential may be trained and appointed as a junior manager at a modest salary, perhaps eliminating the need to hire an expensive MBA graduate.

At the same time, job seekers on the supply side must also take responsibility. They need to shape their résumés in line with labour market demands. An English graduate seeking a journalism job will attract more attention by highlighting her/his published fea-

ture articles rather than essays on Shakespeare. Muchiram understood this: though nearly illiterate, he instructed the person writing his job application not to use correct and polished English.

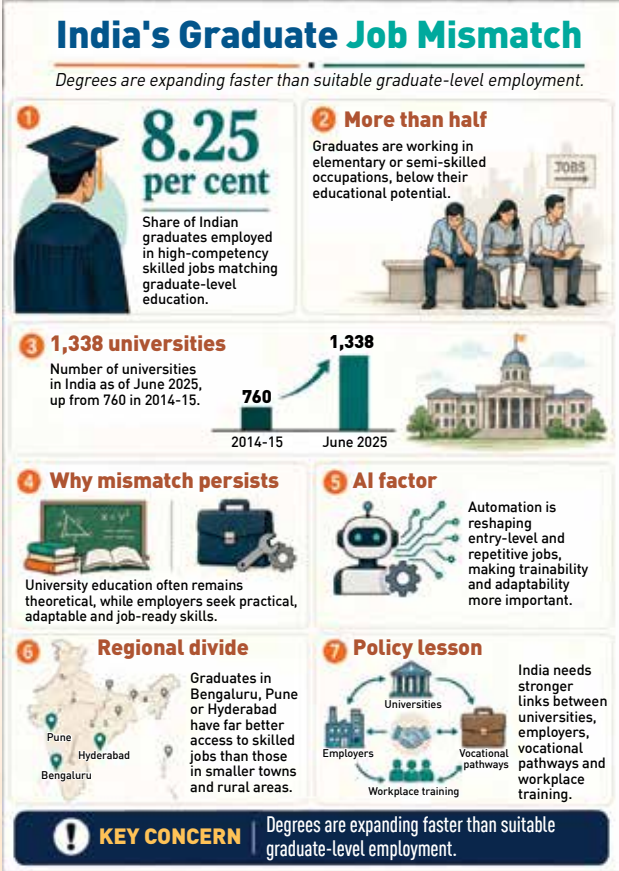
QUALITY OF EDUCATION AND SIGNALLING

Let us now turn to the quality of higher education. Universities today face increasing pressure to expand enrolment. Apart from a few well-known institutions, many universities have fallen prey to this tendency. Grade inflation is another growing concern. As a result, marks and degrees no longer reliably signal quality, making it difficult for employers to distinguish between candidates. This is a slippery slope. As academic standards decline for universities, the demand for their graduates will weaken, eventually eroding the credibility of these institutions in the labour market.

BREAKDOWN OF THE LABOUR MARKET

One of the central principles of economics is that market equilibrium emerges from the interaction of demand and supply. This principle works remarkably well when markets function efficiently. However, in recent years, the labour market has not operated according to this rhythm. Industries seek skills that universities are often unable to provide. Yet, if a proper match between skills and jobs were achieved, young people’s earnings could have risen substantially.

Then, why are our youngsters not acquiring the right skills on their own? Why do they continue to pursue degrees that may not help them in the labour market? In a research paper co-authored with Anurag Banerjee and Elisa Keller, we showed that acquiring such marketable skills involves both high cost and uncertainty. After investing significant effort in learning a specific skill, one may discover that demand for it



has already vanished. That may be a reason why students continue to pursue a general line of education.

AI AND STRUCTURAL CHANGE

The problem has compounded with the advent of AI, which is beginning to automate many repetitive jobs. At the same time, many public and private universities have been established. According to the Press Information Bureau, the number of universities in India rose from 760 in 2014–15 to 1,338 as of June 2025. In such a situation, government intervention is necessary to regulate this vast university system. After consulting experts, the government could determine which universities should become centres of research and excellence, and

where practical and vocational education should be introduced.

It is worth noting that in countries such as Germany and the Netherlands, with stronger vocational pathways and closer links between education and employers, skill mismatch is managed more effectively than in India, though mismatch occurs even there. Governments in these countries regulate the quality of educational institutions through public funding, accreditation, institutional differentiation, and strong vocational pathways. India may also need this kind of regulatory

intervention. The government can also establish training centres where job seekers can learn new technologies.

SHOULD UNIVERSITY EDUCATION BE LIMITED TO A SYLLABUS?

I recall my days at Presidency College, where my teachers often went beyond the syllabus. One macroeconomics teacher would discuss topics not directly relevant to the undergraduate curriculum. Initially, this baffled me. The top student in the class engaged actively with the teacher, while others struggled to follow. In retrospect, this experience proved invaluable. By the time I reached postgraduate studies, many of the concepts were already familiar. What had seemed irrelevant earlier became foundational.

This experience demonstrates that university education should not be confined to a rigid syllabus. Students should be exposed to a wider intellectual horizon that fosters curiosity and creative thinking.

LIMITS OF MARKET-RELEVANT EDUCATION

Universities are not merely skill factories. They are centres of imagination, critical thinking, and intellectual culture. These attributes may not translate immediately into job descriptions required by an employer, but they matter profoundly in the long run. A literature student may not “use” Milton directly in the workplace, but learns interpretation, communication, and sensitivity to language. A philosophy student learns clarity of thought and ethical reasoning. These are not

narrow skills—they are enduring intellectual assets.

SKILLS AND TRAINABILITY

Employers often demand “skills,” but what they truly need is trainability, this is the ability to learn and adapt. In a rapidly changing labour market, specific technical skills can quickly become obsolete. What matters more is the capacity to acquire new skills. Learning is not necessarily an individual process alone. A workplace can be turned into a space of shared collaborative learning. Fierce competition in the workplace could often thwart such shared cooperative learning. However, developing empathy for colleagues, mentoring junior staff members, and interpersonal communication skills can mitigate the harsh competition in the workplace and make colleagues realise that the workplace is not a place of a “zero-sum game” where one worker’s success is another’s failure.

EMPLOYER RESPONSIBILITY

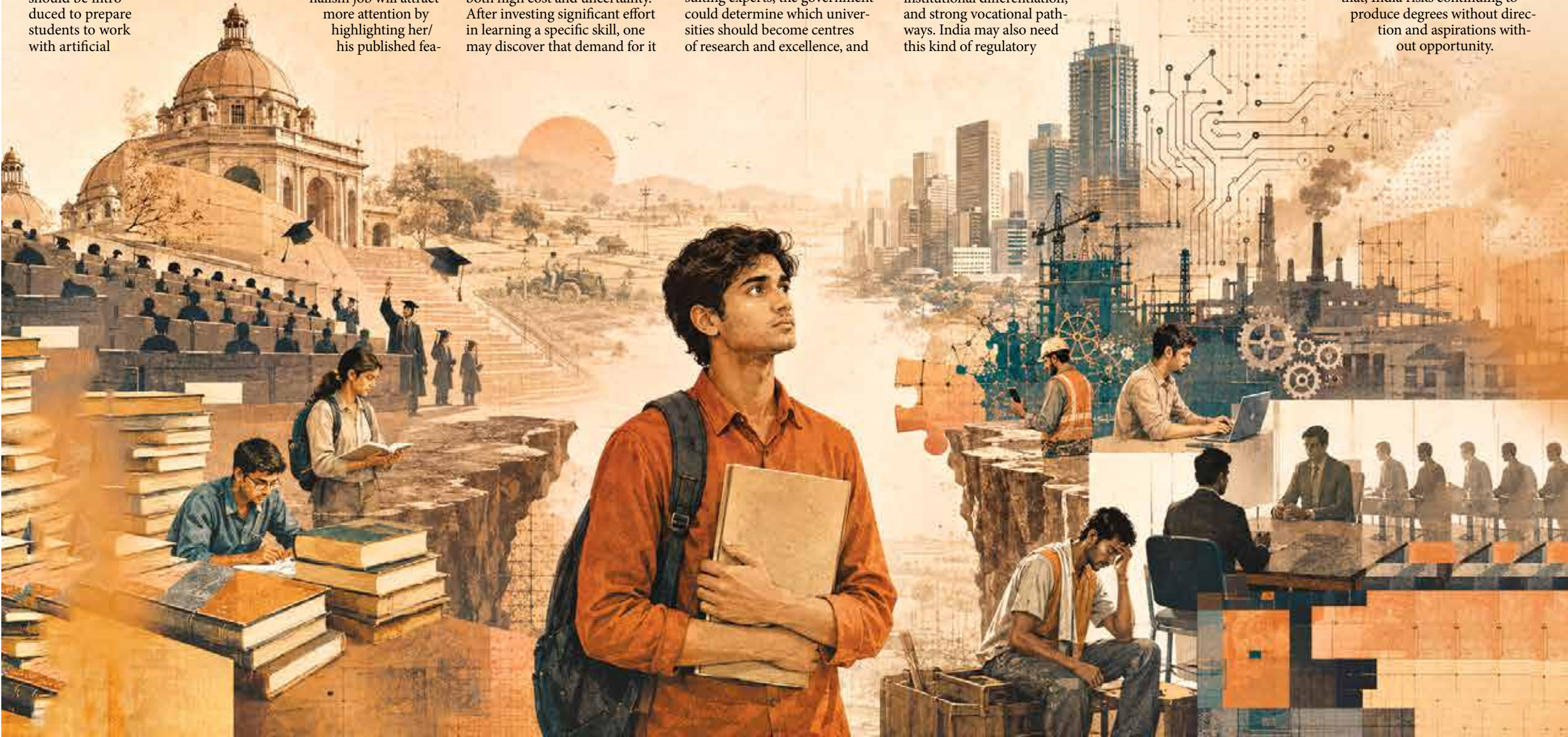
Employers, too, have a role to play. Many firms demand “job-ready” graduates but invest little in training. They expect universities to bear the entire burden of skill formation. It may be rewarding for employers to invest in apprenticeships, internships, and on-the-job training. Partnerships with universities can bridge the gap between theory and practice. Short internships, data literacy workshops, and structured mentoring programmes can help align education with employment. This would benefit the employers in terms of better skill-match which could boost their productivity and profit.

REGIONAL INEQUALITY

India’s labour market is highly heterogeneous. There is a sharp rural–urban divide. A graduate in Bengaluru, Pune, or Hyderabad has very different opportunities compared to one in a small town in Bihar, Odisha, MP or West Bengal. Many capable graduates in rural areas may lack networks, English fluency, or the mobility required to access urban job markets. Also, rural labour markets are narrow and undiversified. Most job opportunities are concentrated on agriculture, low-skilled services, informal work and government schemes (e.g. MGNREGS). Someone with a graduate degree may find it difficult to get a job locally. The cost of migration to cities, both economic and social, can be substantial which may impair social mobility. In a research article with Yoseph Getachew, we have discussed how such adjustment costs of mobility contribute to persistent inequality.

LESSONS FROM MUCHIRAM

What does Muchiram teach us in today’s rapidly changing labour market? Not that education is irrelevant, but that the key lies in aligning skills with the tasks at hand. For this, our youngsters must keep the windings of their minds open. Universities, employers, and policymakers must recognise their shared responsibility. Without that, India risks continuing to produce degrees without direction and aspirations without opportunity.



10

YEAR DIESEL EXILE

20%

ETHANOL SHOCK

85%

BLENDED RUSH



India's Forced Auto Farewell

India's motorists and auto-buyers are paying the price for green policymaking that has been punishing ownership first and answering practical questions later

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

The Indian auto owner has been blessed with a strange new life. A life where a perfectly-healthy luxury diesel SUV with just 48,000 km on the odometer is treated like radioactive waste. A life where a certified 'Pollution Under Control' permit is worth less than the birth certificate of the car. A life where the fuel being pumped into the tank is not what the engine was originally designed to burn, sending the road racing under the driver.

Welcome to India's great auto contradiction, where sustainability is somehow resembling disposability.

THE AGE GUILLOTINE

For lakhs of car-owners in Delhi-NCR, the clock is now as dangerous as the road itself. The National Green Tribunal's 2015 ruling (upheld by the Supreme Court), clinically condemned diesel vehicles older than 10 years and petrol vehicles older than 15 years, regardless of their condition or fitness. Therein begins the absurdity.

A well-loved Toyota Fortuner, Honda City or Benz E-Class that emits within permissible norms and passes all state-mandated pollution tests is still declared 'end-of-life', only because it has blown off too many birthdays candles. Smirking close by in the parking lot, a badly-maintained but younger vehicle belching smoke continues to happily clog Delhi-NCR's roads. This is environmental policy by calendar, not science.

The market adapted the only way it could. Cynically. Delhi's diesel cars began losing value long before they hit the dreaded 10th year. Owners started panic-selling at seven or eight years, if only to salvage some value and transfer the vehicles to states with less draconian rules. Petrol car-owners start glancing at the calendar after the 12th year.

DISPIRITED BUYING

This changed the entire buying behaviour. Diesel sedans practically vanished, with consumers migrating to petrol, hybrids and compact SUVs. This was not because they have wanted to, but because regulation cornered them into doing so. The irony is impossible to ignore. India spent years encouraging



THINGS ARE QUITE
CONFUSING – PERFECTLY
HEALTHY CARS ARE CONDEMNED
BY AGE, WHILE
ethanol-blended
FUELS ARE REWRITING THE
REAL OWNERSHIP
CONTRACT

diesel vehicles through lower fuel pricing – diesel was considered more fuel-efficient. Carmakers invested billions into cleaner BS-IV and BS-VI diesel technologies. Consumers paid premiums for durable diesel engines built to last 300,000 km, or more. Then, suddenly, longevity itself became a crime.

More bewildering is the legal confusion around the policy. In 2025, the Supreme Court temporarily restrained coercive action against owners of older vehicles, clarifying that BS-IV and above vehicles could receive limited protection. The uncertainty has only deepened anxiety. Nobody disputes Delhi's toxic air crisis. But should environmental governance punish actual emissions or the passage of time? That debate refuses to die.

ETHANOL GAMBLE

Just as motorists were adjusting to the age guillotine, in walked another revolution, this time through the fuel nozzle. It came in with E20 blends. After achieving 20-per cent ethanol blending in petrol, India is learnt to be considering E27, E30 and even E85 fuel blends. The government sees ethanol as a strategic masterstroke: lower oil imports, energy security, support for sugarcane farmers and reduced carbon emissions.

On paper, it is brilliant. Inside ageing engines, the reality is less poetic.

Ethanol behaves differently from pure petrol. It absorbs moisture, corrodes rubber and certain metals, and it burns differently. Vehicles not engineered for higher ethanol content can face cracked fuel lines, clogged injectors, degraded seals, cold-start problems and reduced fuel efficiency. Mechanics across India whisper horror stories of fuel pump failures and injector issues in older vehicles.

But motorists have no choice. Pure petrol has disappeared from fuel pumps. Consumers are forced to adapt to the changing chemical composition of fuel without proportionate pricing incentives or consumer education.

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That pricing part matters enormously. Brazil – the world leader in the ethanol success story – adopted a more calibrated approach. Flex-fuel vehicles became mainstream, but over decades. Consumers had the option of choosing between petrol and ethanol, depending on pricing and efficiency. Fuel stations differentiated blends. Ethanol pricing was designed to incentivise adoption. Consumers were treated like participants in a transition, not collateral damage.

India, by contrast, risks turning crores of vehicle owners into involuntary beta-testers.

CONSUMER CASUALTY

The question is not whether India should become greener. It absolutely must. The question is: Why does the financial burden of every transition land disproportionately on the consumer? The middle-class already pays among the world's highest taxes on automobiles and fuel. Cars attract GST rates touching 28 per cent, plus cess. Fuel taxes remain steep. Insurance costs rise annually. Toll networks multiply relentlessly.

After paying all this, owners are expected to junk usable vehicles prematurely and absorb the hidden costs of an evolving fuel chemistry.

There are green contradictions too. Scrapping a functional car carries its own

carbon footprint. Manufacturing a new vehicle consumes enormous energy and raw materials such as steel, aluminium, lithium, plastics and rare earths. Globally, sustainability conversations admit that extending the usable life of well-maintained vehicles can be greener than forcing replacement. Europe, Japan and parts of North America focus heavily on emissions testing, annual fitness standards and low-emission zones, rather than purely age-based bans.

India has chosen a simpler route: arithmetic. Ten years. Fifteen years. Finished.

POLICY PARADOX

There is another mysterious undercurrent. Forced replacements are not terrible for automobile manufacturers, dealerships, financiers or insurers. Every prematurely retired vehicle becomes a fresh sale somewhere in the chain. The automobile industry thrives on churn. And India's auto sector is booming. SUVs dominate the roads. Premiumisation is rising. Luxury car sales are breaking records. Carmakers are celebrating.

But beneath the glitter sits a deep ownership anxiety. Today's Indian buyer no longer asks only: "Can I afford this car?" He/she asks: "Will the law allow me to keep it long enough to justify buying it?"

And that is certainly not a healthy mindset for any mature automobile ecosystem.

SMARTER TRANSITION

Yes, a green transition is necessary in India. But transitions succeed only when they are scientifically credible, economically fair and socially humane.

A more rational framework is quite possible. Fitness-based evaluations, emissions testing, scrappage incentives instead of coercion, differentiated taxation for cleaner older vehicles, ethanol compatibility standards and graded fuel pricing will create a far more balanced system.

If Brazil could build a flexible ethanol ecosystem over decades, India can also avoid springing surprise chemistry experiments on consumers overnight. If a 12-year-old BS-VI diesel SUV emits less pollution than a poorly-maintained newer commercial vehicle, policy should have the nuts and guts to acknowledge measurable reality, instead of blindly worshipping registration dates.

Sustainability cannot become an excuse for institutionalised waste. India's auto owners are willing to adapt. What they resent is being treated as expendable. Somewhere between the scrapyard and the ethanol pump, India risks forgetting that green revolutions work best when citizens are persuaded into them, not cornered.

WELLNESS

HARMLESSNESS MYTH

Most tobacco users want to quit, but nicotine dependence often defeats motivation when medical and behavioural support are missing

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

Still smoking? Still vaping? Still telling yourself it is fine?

Three questions. Three people. One uncomfortable truth.

Mr Cougher: "I've smoked for 12 years. Every time I get a bad cough, I promise myself I'll quit. Then I start again. Is something wrong with me?"

Miss Parent: "My 17-year-old son says vaping is just flavoured water and harmless. Is he right?"

Mr Switcher: "I quit cigarettes and shifted to vaping six months ago. Isn't that progress?"

These three conversations capture most of what people misunderstand about nicotine addiction today.

India is the second-largest consumer of tobacco globally. Tobacco causes over one million deaths every year in the country. Nearly 267 million adults use tobacco in some form, whether cigarettes, bidi, gutkha, khaini, or zarda. At the same time, nearly 70 per cent of users say they want to quit. Yet only 3 to 5 per cent succeed without support.

That gap is not weakness. It is addiction.

To Mr Cougher: Nothing Is "Wrong" With You

Nicotine is one of the most addictive substances in medicine. Within seconds of inhalation, it triggers dopamine release, and the brain rapidly learns to associate it with relief, focus, or comfort. Over time, smoking stops being a choice and becomes a conditioned neurological loop.

Every failed quit attempt is not proof of weak willpower, but evidence of how powerfully nicotine reshapes the brain's reward circuitry. Most people trying to quit without treatment are fighting a biological addiction with motivation alone.

To the Parent: Your Son Is Misinformed

Vapes are not "just water vapour." E-cigarettes produce an aerosol containing nicotine, ultrafine particles, and multiple toxic chemicals that are inhaled deep into the lungs. Many products also contain flavouring compounds linked to lung injury and cellular damage.

More importantly, nicotine affects the adolescent brain differently. Brain development continues until around the age of 25, especially in areas related to attention, impulse control, learning, and emotional regulation.

The candy flavours and sleek designs are engineered to make nicotine feel socially acceptable and psychologically safe. Teenagers need facts, not moral panic. But they do need intervention early.

To the Switcher: Harm Reduction Is Not Harmlessness

Switching from cigarettes to vaping may reduce exposure to some toxic combustion products. That matters. But reduced harm is not the same as safety.

Research increasingly shows that e-cigarette aerosols can still cause inflammation, DNA damage, and injury to blood vessels and lung tissue. Most users also remain dependent on nicotine itself. If someone has completely stopped cigarettes, that is progress.



But the finish line is nicotine freedom, not simply changing the delivery device.

A Practical Quit Plan

Most patients ask the same thing: "How do I quit without ruining my mood, sleep, concentration, or productivity?" Here is a realistic way.

1. Set a Quit Date

Choose a specific date within the next two weeks. Not "someday." A real date. Inform at least one person. Accountability improves outcomes.

2. See a Doctor Early

Do not wait until repeated relapses. Nicotine dependence is a medical condition, and treatment significantly improves success rates.

QUITTING TOBACCO requires more than willpower. Doctors, medication, counselling and family support can turn repeated failed attempts into lasting recovery

3. Use Nicotine

Replacement Therapy Patches, gums, lozenges, and inhalers help reduce withdrawal symptoms while breaking the behavioural habit. Most people stop them too early. Use them consistently for 8 to 12 weeks.

4. Consider Prescription

Medication Medicines such as varenicline or bupropion reduce cravings and withdrawal symptoms. For many smokers, they are first-line treatments, not last resorts.

5. Map Your Triggers

Tea breaks, stress, alcohol, driving, and post-meal cravings are common triggers. Identify your trigger patterns and pre-plan alternatives.

6. Address Mental Health

Smoking and mental health are deeply linked. Anxiety, depression, stress, and nicotine withdrawal often reinforce each other. Treating one while ignoring the other usually fails.

7. Remove Tobacco Completely

No "emergency cigarette." No hidden vape. The first 72 hours are the hardest neurologically. Easy access dramatically increases relapse risk.

8. Use Behavioural Support

India's National Tobacco Cessation Helpline, 1800 11 2356, is free and underused. Counselling combined with medication works far better than motivation alone.

9. Do Not Catastrophise a Slip

One cigarette after quitting is a lapse, not a collapse. Learn from it and continue.

10. Track Milestones

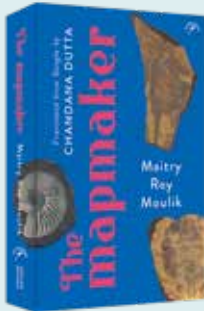
At four weeks, nicotine receptors begin normalising. At three months, habits weaken substantially. At six months, relapse risk drops sharply.

Tobacco addiction is not a bad habit. It is a chronic, treatable medical condition.

Fresh on the shelf

THE MAPMAKER

Publisher: Niyogi Books
Price: Rs 595



The Mapmaker reimagines the remarkable life of William “Strata” Smith, the pioneering geologist whose discovery of stratigraphy transformed our understanding of the Earth. Set against the backdrop of the Enlightenment and Industrial England, the novel explores the collision of scientific genius, class prejudice and institutional gatekeeping. Battling poverty, isolation and betrayal, Smith remained steadfast in his pursuit of knowledge while aristocratic elites sought to diminish his achievements. Richly textured and deeply human, *The Mapmaker* is both a tribute to intellectual courage and a compelling portrait of the personal cost of scientific discovery.

ZUBEEN GARG:
THE VOICE THAT BRIDGED WORLDS

Publisher: Penguin | Price: Rs 399



Zubeen Garg: *The Voice That Bridged Worlds* by Prosenjit Nath is a compelling portrait of one of Northeast India’s most influential cultural icons. Born in Tura and rooted in Assam, Zubeen Garg transformed regional music into a powerful movement that crossed linguistic and geographical boundaries without sacrificing its identity. Tracing his journey from a passionate young musician to a celebrated singer, composer, actor and cultural force, the book explores themes of representation, belonging and artistic integrity. More than a biography, it is the story of a voice that reshaped Assamese culture and amplified an entire region’s presence on the national stage.

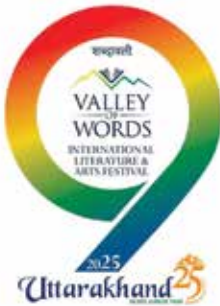
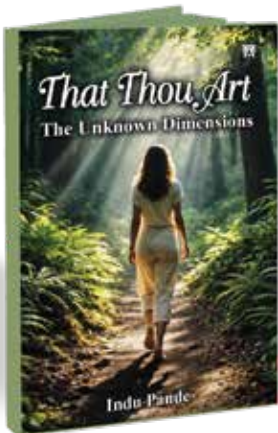
The Search Beyond Reason

Through Anna’s journey, the novel examines trauma, faith, philosophy and the timeless question — Who am I, beyond the mind?

AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA



FOR READERS INTERESTED IN PHILOSOPHY, SPIRITUALITY, PSYCHOLOGY AND THE DIALOGUE BETWEEN EASTERN AND WESTERN THOUGHT, IT OFFERS A REWARDING INTELLECTUAL JOURNEY WHOSE GREATEST STRENGTH LIES NOT IN PROVIDING ANSWERS BUT IN ENCOURAGING DEEPER INQUIRY

Indu Pandé’s *That Thou Art: The Unknown Dimensions* is not an easy read, but the difficulty has its own reward. It is like climbing a tough hill: the trek is exhausting, but the view at the top is recompense for the effort. The protagonist, Anna Lindermier, is the daughter of the Munich-based psychotherapist-clinical psychologist couple Dr Franz and Bertine Lindermier. She had suffered a major childhood trauma when she witnessed the Munich massacre of 1972. A group of Palestinians had shot dead some Israeli athletes in the Olympic Village, not on account of any individual rivalry against any one of them, but for the flag they carried and the passport they held.

After studying psychiatry at the University of Heidelberg and the Jung Institute of Analytical Psychology, Zurich, Anna began her teaching career at the Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich. It was in Zurich that she was initiated into the works of Keyserling, whose *Diary of a Philosopher* stated that “new psychology was nothing but a rediscovery of what was already known by the ancient seers of India”. Convinced that India was “the birthplace of contemplative psychology, where the ontological base and the epistemological superstructure are in harmony”, she set out to find a Guru to bridge the gap between “critical reason and supra-rational intuition”.

This introduction is necessary to foreground that her deep quest to discover answers was rooted in the philosophical tradition of the West. She had read Plato, Aristotle and Socrates, Aquinas, Descartes, Berkeley, Goethe, Kant, Hegel, Schopenhauer and, of course, the modern psychoanalysts and existentialists Freud, Jung, Adler and Simone de Beauvoir, but obviously the questions in her mind, especially about how and why “civilised” societies engage in violence, remained unresolved.

Her Indian sojourn starts at Aahna — an upscale resort close to Corbett Park — named after the legendary Jim Corbett, who became a conservationist after having been a trophy hunter. Her next stop is Rishikesh. En route, her driver-interlocutor Prem Singh explains the plethora and hierarchy of local

gods, from Gram Devata, Kul Devata and Sthan Devata to a host of malevolent and benevolent deities. He tells her about Jagar, the shaman-like ritual, as well as the legend of Nanda Devi. While at Rishikesh, she picks up books on Yoga by Swami Krishnananda and Sri Aurobindo. The bookshop owner directs her to an “old-fashioned ashram” whose inmates were followers of Krishnananda, and this sets the context for her onward journey to Tripatha Ashram in Harshil. While on the winding mountain roads, she wonders: if philosophers could have travelled across space and time, what kind of conversations would Immanuel Kant and Sigmund Freud have had with Patanjali and Krishan Dwaipayana Vyas?

The Tripatha Ashram was located on the banks of the Jalandhari, a tributary of the Bhagirathi. Here she meets Rohitashwa, or Rohit for short, who tells her the stories of Trishanku and Nachiketa to explain the *mysterium tremendum et fascinans* of life. She wants to hear his story, but he first narrates to her the tale of this unique ashram, which received substantial funding from its European patrons.

The story of Tripatha’s founder, Madhav, begins at the Rishikesh ashram of Swami Someshwaranand, who identifies him as a *mumukshu*, an aspirant seeking *moksha*. Madhav joins the Gurukul Kangri at Haridwar for a deeper study of the *Atharvaveda*, the foundational text of Ayurveda. After his graduation, he joins the Someshwaranand ashram as a practitioner-teacher of both Yoga and

Ayurveda. It is here that Veronica — the sophisticated sexual seductress — tries to tempt him, but there is a twist in the tale. She had not bargained for her vulnerability in a two-way relationship, for the peace and tranquillity of the monastic set-up affected her deeply. Her relationship with Madhav became one of mutual respect and positive collaboration for a cause. He accompanies her to Italy to teach Yoga at the ski resort of Abetone in Tuscany. Here, he also delves into a deep study of Dante’s *Divine Comedy*. Was the journey to *Paradiso* possible only through *Inferno* and *Purgatory*?

During his five years in Europe, he drew lessons from the Renaissance, Italian art, architecture and design, German engineering and French cuisine. He also absorbed the landscapes of the Alps and the Mediterranean. But when Madhav yearns to return to his ancestral home at Harshil, Veronica and her influential friends extend their financial support for the establishment of the Tripatha Ashram.

Anna insists on hearing Rohit’s journey as well. He starts with the story of his kaleidoscope. As a child, he had dissembled the “magical toy” that gave him innumerable patterns of colours, shapes and symmetries. This led him to realise that the magic was not in the parts but in the configuration thereof. Over time, this led him to the realisation that even “as we assume all objects to be static, the universe is actually a movement conditioned

by space-time, and changing every moment”. During a trip to Rishikesh when he was fifty, he met Leonardo Veritiero, a marine engineer, and their first discussion was on the sinking of the Titanic in the freezing waters of the North Atlantic. Rohit acknowledged that some of his first Vedantic insights came from his conversations with Leonardo. This went to show that the knowledge of the East could be well understood and propagated by Western adherents as well.

ANNA’S QUESTIONS

We now come to Anna’s questions, starting with *Ko ’ham*: Who am I? Rohit then explains to her the four *Mahavakyas* — *Pragyanam Brahman*: consciousness is the Absolute; *Aham Brahmasmi*: I am the Absolute; *Tat Tvam Asi*: Thou Art That; and *Ayam Atma Brahman*: My Self is the Absolute. Anna asks, “Why is it that a copy of the *Bhagwat Gita* is kept in all the rooms?” The answer comes from Sri Aurobindo, who describes it “as a scripture which professes Vedantic Yoga, an amalgam of Karma Yoga, the yoga of action, with Gyan Yoga, the yoga of knowledge, and Bhakti Yoga, the yoga of devotion”. Rohit also explains to her that Lord Krishna’s discourse was about elevating his disciple’s psycho-physical consciousness to a spiritual level where physics and metaphysics were the same.

The discussion then moves on to the Categorical Imperative of Kant, which finds resonance with *Nishkama Karma* in one’s own *Swadharma*: action as a duty without any regard to outcome. The Hypothetical Imperative, on the other hand, is *Naimittik Karma*, where action is performed to ensure a desirable outcome. Rohit then tells her the lore of Valmiki, Prajapati, Narada, Janaka and Buddha. These narratives contained profound truths in simple language for the householder and the layperson to understand deeper metaphysical questions. Acharya Shankar’s commentary on the Upanishads, and his ability to galvanise all of Bharat in his short life of thirty-two years, leave Anna wondering if such a person existed in flesh and blood, for unlike the earlier seers, there was a definite timeline to his birth, travels and establishments — and the Tripatha Ashram also claimed a definite affiliation to Badrinath and Kedarnath Dhams.

Were there any final solutions, or clear-cut answers? She realises on her return flight that the final message of the *Bhagwat Gita* was contained in the aphorism *Yadiccha Tada Kuru* (Chapter 18, Verse 63): “*You have access to all the knowledge; ponder over it completely, and then do as you wish.*”



GASTRONOMY

RAW MANGO COCONUT RICE



INGREDIENTS

- » 2 cups cooked rice (preferably cooled)
- » 1 medium raw mango, peeled and grated (about 1 cup)
- » 1 cup freshly grated coconut
- » 2 tbsp coconut oil or vegetable oil
- » 1 tsp mustard seeds
- » 1 tsp urad dal
- » 1 tsp chana dal
- » 2 dried red chillies, broken
- » 2 green chillies, finely chopped
- » 10–12 curry leaves
- » ¼ tsp turmeric powder
- » 2 tbsp roasted peanuts or cashew nuts
- » Salt to taste
- » Fresh coriander leaves for garnish (optional)

DIRECTIONS

Spread the cooked rice on a large plate and allow it to cool completely. This helps the grains remain separate and prevents the rice from becoming sticky during mixing. Heat the oil in a heavy-bottomed pan over medium heat. Add the mustard seeds and allow them to splutter. Stir in the urad dal and chana dal, and sauté until they turn golden brown. Add the dried red chillies, green chillies and curry leaves, and cook for another 30 seconds until fragrant. Mix in the turmeric powder, followed by the grated raw mango. Sauté for 2–3 minutes. The mango should soften slightly but retain its fresh, tangy flavour. Add the grated coconut and stir gently for another minute. Do not overcook, as the coconut should remain moist and aromatic. Add the cooled rice to the pan and season with salt. Using a flat spatula, gently fold the rice into the mango-coconut mixture until every grain is evenly coated. Stir in the roasted peanuts or cashew nuts for added crunch. Remove from the heat and let the rice rest for five minutes before serving. Garnish with fresh coriander leaves if desired.



TIP

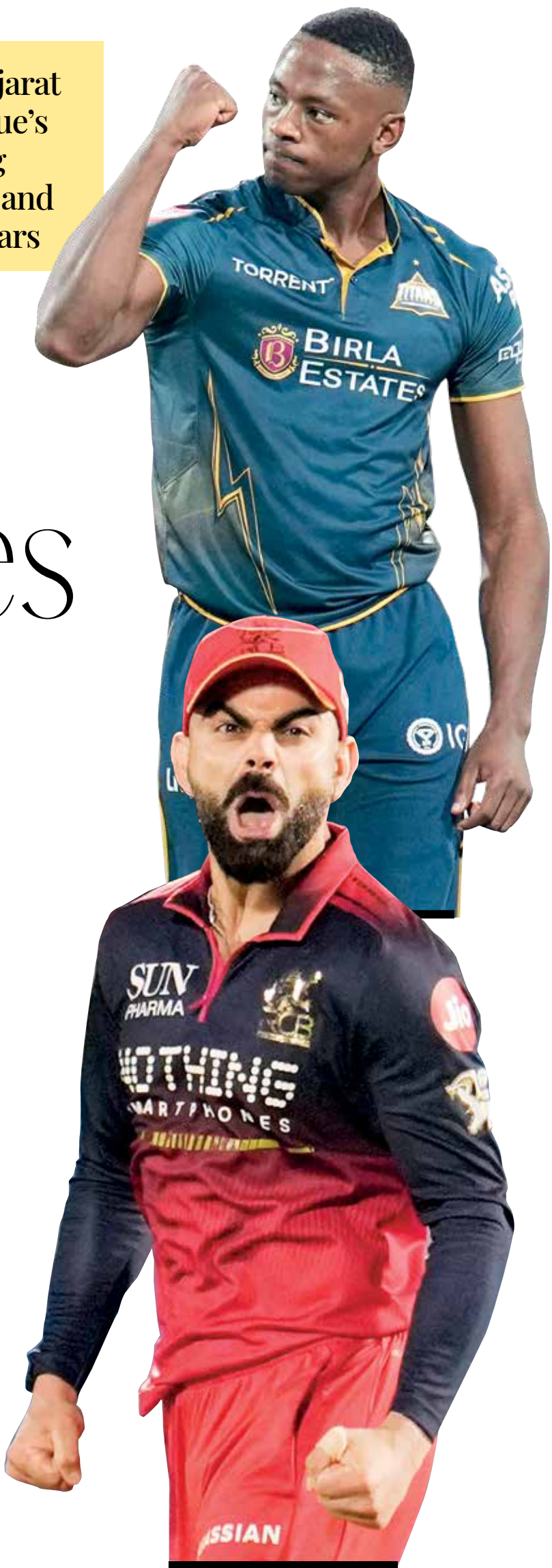
Serve with chilled curd, papad or a simple cucumber salad for a wholesome summer meal





As Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Gujarat Titans prepare for the IPL final, the league's 2026 season reflects changing cricketing power centres, fresh ownership models and the emergence of a new generation of stars

One Final, Many Stories



AUTHOR



S KANNAN

All roads will lead to the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad this evening as the Indian Premier League (IPL) final between Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Gujarat Titans is held under the glare of the floodlights. For those who have followed the whiz-thud action since March 28 this year, it has been riveting. For those who love sixes (thrill) and spills (dropped catches), there is nothing like

RISHABH PANT HAS QUIT *captaincy* AT LUCKNOW SUPER GIANTS AND HARDIK PANDYA IS PACKING UP FROM MUMBAI INDIANS

the IPL to get the adrenaline flowing. And yet, there are some cynical folks who view everything in life critically — IPL is boring, there is cricket fatigue, and there is a drop in viewership. If you belong to that school of thought, there is something drastically wrong. OK, you may not have watched every match and every minute over the last two months, but if trends are to be picked up, the IPL was simply unmissable.

Then again, for those who complain that Ahmedabad is hardly a city for sports, how the capital of vibrant Gujarat has embraced a multitude of sporting action across disciplines is also an engaging story. In fact, the old image of the city being dull and boring, or, to borrow a phrase from the youth, “not a happening city”, has undergone a sea change.

So, Ahmedabad as the host of the IPL final is the answer to such preposterous theories of boredom and a lack of cricketing culture. If anything, given the size of the stadium and its modern design, and considering how Ahmedabad has hosted major ICC events in the past, leaving traditional venues behind, it marks a significant change. Add to it dashing skipper Shubman Gill leading Gujarat Titans into the final to a century, and there is no way you can mock Ahmedabad.

Indeed, it is a topic of great discussion today that Bengaluru's Chinnaswamy Stadium was denied hosting rights for the knockout matches and the IPL final. The reasons are not political, really, but rather how politicians from the Congress-ruled state of Karnataka were becoming increasingly greedy. A stadium with a limited capacity of around 33,000 had to give away 3,000 free passes to netas. Such a practice had to be nipped in the bud, since the public at large has a right to watch an IPL final by paying for tickets.

There are many finals that have been held in Ahmedabad — the ICC Cricket World Cup final in 2023 (ODI format), the T20 World Cup final earlier this year, and now the IPL final. Nobody playing inside the stadium has complained that the venue is boring or lacks energy. On the contrary, Ahmedabad is going to host more sporting events, with the 2030 Centennial Commonwealth Games also lined up. All this is good for the city and the several



FEARLESS AT FIFTEEN

At just 15, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has emerged as the breakout star of IPL 2026. Fearless against world-class bowlers, the Rajasthan Royals batter combined audacious strokeplay with remarkable maturity. His string of match-winning knocks has made him one of Indian cricket's most exciting prospects for the future.

ecosystems that operate around the IPL. Mind you, it is not just restricted to these two months of matches but also provides employment throughout the year.

Frankly speaking, what has defined this year in the IPL is the use of more venues and more arenas to host matches. Taking T20 cricket to a place like Dharamsala, where the sylvan settings offer visual relief, cannot be scoffed at. And what a cracker of a match was won by Royal Challengers Bengaluru against Gujarat Titans, where RCB skipper Rajat Patidar came alive. With the bat, Patidar has been a sensation. He did miss a century, but the way he has led the side over two years under the highest levels of scrutiny marks him out as a great leader. To borrow a phrase from Virat Kohli, it seems surreal that RCB, which had been riled and ridiculed until they won the title in 2025, are now the obvious favourites.

Indeed, the whole energy around RCB has changed magically. When the IPL began this year, there was uncertainty as the ownership of RCB had changed hands. Big bucks were spent. Those who invested will be happy that the returns are tangible. To say that the IPL 'sale' is about buying a successful product is just one aspect. More importantly, for businessmen to spend massive sums of money and feel empowered is a sign that even when there is a shaky economic situation due to war, the IPL remains resilient.

To be sure, whether it is RCB or Rajasthan Royals, which also saw a

change of hands this year, the results in the IPL 2026 edition have been mind-blowing. For the passionate fans of Chennai Super Kings, Mumbai Indians and even Punjab Kings, the way two teams based in Bengaluru and Jaipur have produced top-class results is an education. Results come through the process, not merely by fluke. And for two teams that were acquired after in-depth valuation, the success in acquiring RCB and Rajasthan Royals will offer pointers for the future. Nothing can stop more teams from changing hands in the years ahead.

Viewed dispassionately, not everything that happened in the IPL 2026 edition was right. If RCB, Rajasthan Royals and Gujarat Titans got it right, the disappointment over flop shows by CSK, MI and KKR cannot be glossed over. Perhaps these teams will look at what Bengaluru and Jaipur have done right and learn from it. Performance cannot be judged by cricketing action alone. Beyond the boundary, there are many men and women who ideate, spend hours analysing data and ensure results are delivered. The “chalta hai yaar” attitude will not work in the IPL anymore. It is serious business, and only teams that can peak, sustain intensity, experience a dip in form and then peak again will survive two-plus months of razor-sharp competition.

You cannot have a side loaded with stars and still fail, as has been the case with Mumbai Indians. Nor can you have a side like CSK simply riding on

past glory without a clear vision of what it wants to achieve. And if you look at KKR, Shah Rukh Khan, who holds major stakes, will definitely want to know what went wrong. It is easy to lambast captain Ajinkya Rahane and call him a failure. Surely, before the next IPL in 2027, teams will reset, reboot and look ahead. The way Eden Gardens ignored the IPL was not funny. Fans want to see their side winning. So expect major changes, or rather a shake-up, wherever results have been poor.

Back to the two men who lit up the IPL for RCB and Rajasthan Royals, it is obvious that Patidar and 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi are destined for bigger things. The Indian national T20 team needs them. Patidar is the ultimate professional and brings immense value. Sooryavanshi, now worshipped by fans and hailed by legends like Sachin Tendulkar, Chris Gayle and Yuvraj Singh, is a maverick. Or perhaps a marvel. He has produced audacious strokeplay. Imagine, a boy from Bihar taking on the biggest bowlers without fear. He whacks the ball long and hard and tells us he plays the ball, not the bowler. Three scores in the nineties during the IPL's climactic phase define Vaibhav Sooryavanshi as someone ready for the next level. Most importantly, he still needs to be protected.

Vaibhav may have been taught how to smash the ball in the nets by his coaches and mentors, but the maturity with which he speaks defines him as a humble boy. As a role model for youngsters — boys and girls alike — watching Sooryavanshi touch the feet of Sunil Gavaskar and other commentators shows he has been groomed well at home in Bihar. Massive respect to his mother and father, a middle-class family, for raising a kid who has both manners and pedigree. The world loves champions who are

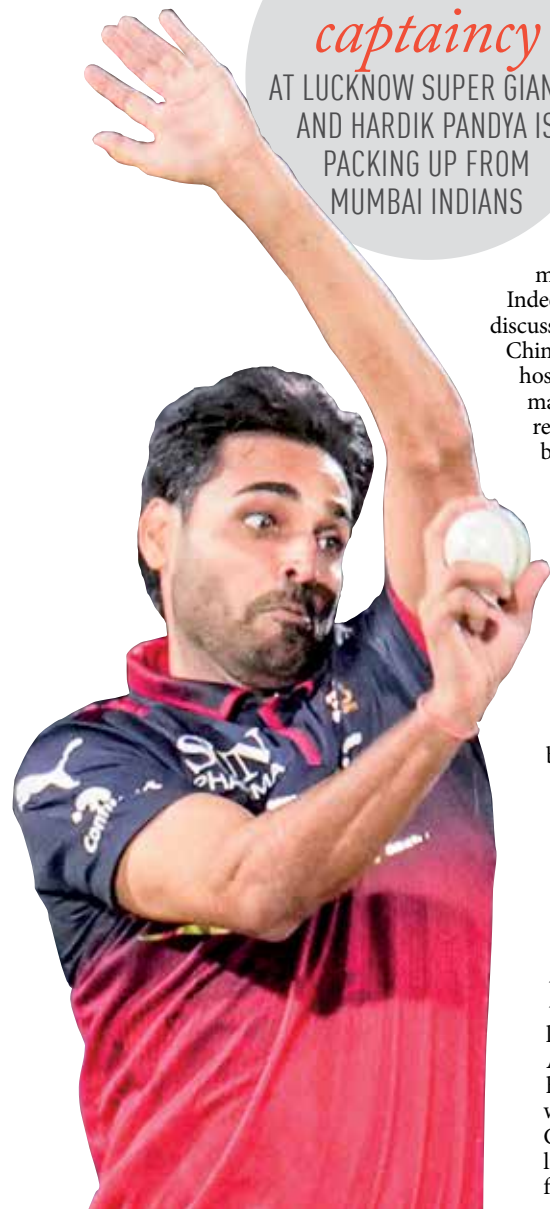
humble and respectful.

Any day, fans will embrace Vaibhav Sooryavanshi rather than a Hardik Pandya or an Arshdeep Singh. If IPL 2026 has given us something truly special, it is Vaibhav — the baby who bats like a maestro. Born for greatness or groomed to become a celebrity, Vaibhav has everything needed to shine. After all, he not only has a name derived from the Sun God but also traits that reflect energy and brilliance. And we even heard someone like R. Ashwin say this boy should have a “nazar ka tika” applied. That is Vaibhav Sooryavanshi for you.

As the crowds in Ahmedabad experience ecstasy tonight, do remember one more rock star — Virat Kohli. How he has been the cerebral force at RCB has been defining. Every day he makes you more emotional. Every performance from King Kohli and every video interview of his resonates. How he pushes his body at the age of 37 and remains a front-runner to represent India in the ICC ODI World Cup next year is something from which a lot can be learned.

What defines Kohli is that he plays with passion and for Bengaluru, a city he loves. This is the beauty of the IPL — how a boy from New Delhi becomes a superstar and then embraces a city that has given him love and affection. This is indeed defining, as the romance of the IPL adds one more glorious chapter to its manuscript.

Of course, from a local Ahmedabad angle, the boy-turned-man from Punjab, Shubman Gill, now piloting Gujarat Titans into the title round, is equally defining. Captain of India in two formats — Tests and ODIs — Gill's performances in the 2026 edition of the IPL cannot be overlooked. He has batted robustly and also shown that he can lead with relish in this harsh summer.



'We live in slightly difficult times as creative people'

Bollywood actress Sonakshi Sinha said it's difficult to speak the 'whole and entire truth' in today's time

It's difficult to speak the 'whole and entire truth' in today's time, said Sonakshi Sinha, stressing that artists have become careful with the subjects they want to explore in movies.

Asked whether mainstream cinema resists the hard truth in its narrative, Sinha said it is not always possible to depict reality.

"If you speak the truth too much, the film also stops in today's time. It's difficult to speak the whole and entire truth. So, I think people are much more careful with the subjects that they're choosing, with the truth they want to get out there and what they're trying to convey. I think we live in slightly difficult times as creative people; we don't have that freedom anymore," the actor told PTI in an interview.

Sinha debuted in Hindi cinema with the 2010 movie 'Dabangg', co-starring Salman Khan. The film was a major success and there was no looking back for the actor, who went on to deliver critically acclaimed performances in 'Lootera', 'Akira', 'Mission Mangal' and OTT shows 'Dahaad' and 'Heeramandi'.

Looking back at her journey of over 15 years in movies, Sinha said the industry is different from when she joined movies and one of the reasons is the rise of social media. "It's gotten tougher, I feel, because there was not that much exposure. There was social media and now it has become huge. So, I feel I came at a slightly nicer time and things just started going down from there," she said.

The actress said experience has helped her make better choices, while also bring-

ing about a change in her as a person. "As an actor and as a person, you grow up. I was literally a baby when I started working, so a lot of changes come to you organically while you're working. I feel I'm a much different person than I was then," she said.

Sinha admitted that some projects have left her with 'nightmares' and regrets, but she would never disown them. "You end up becoming a part of it because it was a certain way, but then it gets made a certain way. Things change while you're shooting and then you're just miserable, like, 'What have I signed up for?' Then your quality of work also goes down. You just don't want to be there, so I feel stuff like that has happened to me. But I would never disown a film.

I did it in 'hosh o havaas' (right senses). Whatever I have to do, I have to do it well and then move on.



Everybody makes mistakes in their life. We are also the same. You just have to move on."

Sinha currently stars in 'System', a legal drama which also stars Jyothika and actor-filmmaker Ashutosh Gowariker. In the movie, she features as lawyer Neha Rajvansh, who must prove herself in front of her hot-shot lawyer father (Gowariker). Initially, determined to win all the cases that come to her, Sinha's character starts questioning the idea of winning at all costs.

ASKED
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Tiwari of 'Nil Battey Sannata' and 'Bareilly ki Barfi' fame, turned out to be a fun experience for the actor. She praised Tiwari as an entertaining and fun-loving person who could easily conjure up vulnerable and yet 'grounded in reality' characters through the legal drama. "The seriousness of this film, of situations and of the subject... I think it demanded something really different from her as well because this isn't the kind of film that she has been making in the past. It was a very different way to go for her and I think she manoeuvred that really well and it

was really refreshing to see her kind of bring out something like what she did in 'System'."

Similarly, she shared a good rapport with Jyothika and said she would love to collaborate with her again. "We really enjoyed working with each other, I mean, I feel like our work ethic is very similar. I felt like this is a nice person to work with, to have on the set and she is such a fabulous actor. I think that really elevates your own performance. I mean, I think it was great, I would love to work with her again."

Sinha said her character, Neha Rajvansh, is a 'very real, very flawed' person who is trying to do the right thing. "She is someone who stands up for her values and her principles. She will fight to get it right. For me, it was a very interesting character to play because I have never played a lawyer before. The whole courtroom scenes were fun for me as an actor. I think overall it was something that I just kind of became."

Sinha also recalled her conversations with Gowariker, who once told her how he started as an actor but ended up becoming a renowned director who gave hits such as 'Lagaan', 'Jodha Akbar' and 'Swades'. Before his foray into direction, Gowariker had worked on movies such as 'Kamla Ki Maut', 'Salim Langde Pe Mat Ro', 'Kabhi Haan Kabhi Naa', 'Chamatkar' and shows 'Bharat Ek Khoj' and 'Circus'.

"He's a very good actor. So, I asked him also and he said, 'I actually came to become an actor'. And then he ended up directing. So, he's really got it. I think he was just perfect for this role. He's playing my father and he's playing a full shark of a lawyer and he's done it really well."

PTI

'IT IS A VERY FRESH WELCOME HERE'

Jyotika said it's refreshing to see more shades being explored for women over 40 in Hindi cinema

South actress Jyotika said it is refreshing to see more shades being explored for women over 40 in Hindi cinema, particularly in the streaming space.

Jyotika, who was last seen in Hindi series 'Dabba Cartel', stars in Prime's original movie 'System', which also features Sonakshi Sinha and Ashutosh Gowariker.

Directed by Ashwini Iyer Tiwari, the courtroom thriller focuses on a privileged prosecutor (Sinha) who teams up with a humble stenographer (Jyothika) to uncover buried injustices, forcing a choice between power and justice, reads the official synopsis.

"It is a very fresh welcome here. I find them writing some amazing roles for 40-plus women. I'm seeing diversity and I'm seeing the greys and a lot of different kinds of characters being played here. So, it is amazing," Jyothika told PTI in an interview.

In her almost three-decade-long career with more than 50 films to her credit, Jyotika said her focus in the past decade has shifted towards scripts about women's empowerment.

"Because we're still in a huge theatre space there, roles are written from a male gaze point of view... I love what I have done there and I'm still going to continue in the south. I still feel there are more shades being written here in Hindi cinema, the reason for that being OTT. I think it has really taken off more in the Hindi stream. So, we have very diverse characters written for women here. So, I'm enjoying both sides," she added.



was a joy. "She is fabulous. We are very similar; we are on time, we believe in similar concepts and similar kinds of films. I think she has also made some wonderful choices all through her career and I feel we just connected, when you connect in real life, then cinema just happens," she said.

Known for South films such as 'Khushi', 'Dumm Dumm Dumm', 'Dhool', 'Kaakha Kaakha', 'Kaatrin Mozhi', 'Raatchasi' and 'Ponmagal Vandhal' and in Hindi with projects such as 'Shaitan', 'Srikant' and 'Dabba Cartel', said actors change with time.

"When you get into acting as a teenager, all you want to do is work with all the stars and make your money. You want to get into the big films and you want to just carve that path to stardom. Then after you've done 10-15 films, you sort of grow up and then you also respect yourself more as an actor and you mature and then you start picking your lot. Then again comes a phase where you start saying no to 90 per cent of what is coming and just pick what gives you a good sleep at night," she said.

The actress added, "As an artist, it was an extremely interesting role for me to play and I felt it was challenging because there are a lot of silent moments for Sarika in the film and performing through silence is very demanding and very satisfying and that is something I feel is very special about Sarika in this film."

Jyothika said working with Sinha

PTI



WHAT'S COMING NEXT?

From 'Made in India: A Titan Story' to 'Dhurandhar 2', here is a selection of new OTT offerings for you to enjoy

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Ranging from drama, action, thriller, mystery and comedy, enjoy the week with new films and shows from 'Netflix' ('Maa Behen'), 'Prime Video' ('Made in India...', 'Clarkson's Farm' S5 and 'The Legend of Vox Machina' S4) and 'Jio Hotstar' ('Dhurandhar 2')!

MADE IN INDIA...

Starring Naseeruddin Shah and Jim Sarbh in lead roles, the series chronicles the creation of the timeless 'Titan' watches. To stream on 'Prime Video' from June 3, the series is inspired by Vinay Kamath's acclaimed book.



CLARKSON'S FARM S5



The new season of the much-loved 'Prime Video' series is set to be released on June 3, as Britain's farmer Jeremy Clarkson sets out on another journey full of fun and adventure!

THE LEGEND OF VOX MACHINA S4

To be released on June 3, season four of the 'Prime Video' series picks up a year after the defeat of the Chroma Conclave. Vox Machina's members are forced to reunite when a dangerous new apocalyptic threat known as the 'Whispered One' emerges.



MAA BEHEN



The upcoming 'Netflix' crime-comedy film, starring Madhuri Dixit Nene, Triptii Dimri, Dharna Durga and others, follows a dysfunctional mother-daughter trio who must team up to hide a dead body from their nosy neighbours. It'll stream on June 4.

DHURANDHAR 2

The highly anticipated sequel of the 'Dhurandhar' saga is all set to mark its digital debut on June 4 on OTT streamer 'Jio Hotstar' and this time, the stakes to fight, survive and bring the enemies to an end are definitely higher than ever!

